



DEPARTAMENTO DE DESARROLLO
PRODUCTIVO Y TECNOLÓGICO

LICENCIATURA EN SISTEMAS

TALLER DE INGLÉS II

HANDOUT

CONTENT LIST

- UNIT 1 - BUILDING A CAREER IN TECH
- UNIT 2 - WHEN SYSTEMS FAIL
- UNIT 3 - PLANNING THE NEXT RELEASE
- UNIT 4 - CYBERSECURITY RULES AND RISK MANAGEMENT
- UNIT 5 - HYPOTHETICAL SOLUTIONS AND LESSONS LEARNED
- UNIT 6 - HOW DATA AND SYSTEMS WORK
- UNIT 7 - CHOOSING THE RIGHT TECHNOLOGY
- UNIT 8 - TEAM COMMUNICATION AND PROJECT REPORTING
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TALLER DE INGLES

UNIT 1

NIVEL 2

Lic. en Sistemas | Dpto. de inglés

Unit 1

Building a Career in Technology



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

1. **identify and use key vocabulary and professional collocations** related to IT careers, qualifications, technical skills and professional development;
2. **differentiate between completed past events, professional experience and continuing activities** by accurately using the Past Simple, Present Perfect Simple and Present Perfect Continuous;
3. **use time expressions such as *for, since, just, already* and *yet*** to describe achievements, unfinished goals and ongoing learning processes;
4. **analyse written and spoken professional profiles** to identify relevant information about education, work experience, technical competencies, achievements and career goals;
5. **conduct a structured peer interview** by asking and answering questions about previous experience, recent achievements and continuing professional development;
6. **deliver a guided professional progress update** describing their career background, completed projects, current training and future objectives with clarity, accuracy and coherence.

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT – “Building a Career in Technology”

" Building a Career in Tech: Learning, Adapting and Growing"

_____ For many university students, beginning a career in technology involves more than learning programming languages. Employers also expect clear communication, problem-solving and continuous learning. Lucía Fernández, a junior cloud support specialist, has discovered that professional growth requires technical knowledge and adaptability.

_____ Lucía became interested in technology while studying Systems at university. In her second year, she created a simple mobile application with three classmates. The project was not particularly advanced, but it taught her how to divide responsibilities, meet deadlines and explain technical decisions. She later completed a six-month internship at a small software company, where she supported users and documented common system errors.



_____ After graduating, Lucía joined a cloud services provider. Since then, she has worked with several development teams and has helped migrate two applications to cloud-based environments. She has already completed courses in Linux administration and network security, but she has not obtained a professional cloud certification yet. Her managers have recently given her more responsibility.

_____ At present, Lucía is preparing for that certification while working full-time. She has been studying container technology for four months and has been practising troubleshooting through online labs. The process has sometimes been demanding, especially when urgent support tickets have interrupted her study routine. However, she believes that regular practice has made her more confident.

_____ Lucía has also learnt that communication is essential in IT. During her internship, she often used highly technical language with non-specialist users, which caused confusion. Now she asks clearer questions, explains solutions step by step and checks that users have understood her instructions. These strategies have improved both her customer support and her teamwork.

_____ Although Lucía has achieved several professional goals, she considers her career a continuing process. Technology changes quickly, so professionals must update their knowledge throughout their working lives. For Lucía, success does not mean knowing every tool. It means remaining curious, learning from experience and being prepared for the next challenge.

ACTIVITY 1 – Predicting from the Title

Look at the title, “Building a Career in Tech: Learning, Adapting and Growing.”

Based on the title and your knowledge of the technology industry, what topics do you think the text will discuss? Mention at least three.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

ACTIVITY 2 – Read the text quickly. What is its main purpose? Choose the correct option and justify your answer briefly.

- a) To explain how cloud-based applications are developed and maintained.
- b) To describe how an IT professional has developed her career through education, experience and continuous learning.
- c) To compare university courses with professional technology certifications.

Justification:

ACTIVITY 3 – Read the text again and match each paragraph with the most appropriate subheading. There are TWO extra subheadings that you do not need to use.

Subheadings

- A. Improving Communication Through Experience
- B. Preparing for a New Professional Qualification
- C. Professional Development After Graduation
- D. Creating a Successful Software Company
- E. The Different Skills Required in the Technology Industry
- F. Early Experiences with Technology and Teamwork
- G. Choosing Between University and Full-Time Employment
- H. Professional Growth as a Continuous Process

Paragraph Subheading

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____
- 4 _____
- 5 _____
- 6 _____

ACTIVITY 4 – Read the statements and decide whether they are True (T) or False (F) according to the text.

- 1. Employers are mainly interested in candidates' knowledge of programming languages. T / F
- 2. Lucía's university project helped her develop organizational and communication skills. T / F
- 3. Lucía completed her first internship after graduating from university. T / F
- 4. Lucía has participated in the migration of two applications since joining the cloud services provider. T / F
- 5. Lucía has already obtained a professional cloud certification. T / F
- 6. Urgent support requests have sometimes affected Lucía's study routine. T / F
- 7. Lucía always communicated effectively with non-specialist users during her internship. T / F
- 8. Lucía believes that successful IT professionals must know how to use every available technological tool. T / F

ACTIVITY 5 – Work with a partner. Answer the questions and then compare your answers.

- 1. Why does beginning a career in technology involve more than learning programming languages?
- 2. What did Lucía learn while developing the mobile application?
- 3. What responsibilities did she have during her internship?
- 4. What has Lucía achieved since joining the cloud services provider?
- 5. How long has she been studying container technology?
- 6. Why has preparing for the certification sometimes been difficult?
- 7. How has Lucía changed the way she communicates with non-specialist users?
- 8. According to Lucía, what does professional success in technology mean?

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 6 – Go back to the reading text. Match the terms in Column A with their correct definitions in Column B.

Column A		Column B
1. adaptability	___	A. A period of practical work experience completed by a student or recent graduate.
2. deadlines	___	B. The process of identifying and solving technical problems.
3. internship	___	C. Requiring considerable time, effort or attention.
4. migrate	___	D. The ability to change your behaviour or methods in response to new situations.
5. certification	___	E. The development of a person's professional knowledge, abilities and career.
6. troubleshooting	___	F. A person who does not possess expert knowledge of a particular subject.
7. demanding	___	G. To move data, applications or systems from one environment to another.
8. confident	___	H. Specific dates or times by which tasks must be completed.
9. non-specialist	___	I. An official qualification that confirms a particular professional skill.
10. professional growth	___	J. Feeling certain about your abilities, knowledge or decisions.

ACTIVITY 7 – Complete the sentences using the expressions from the box. There is ONE extra expression that you do not need to use.

communicate clearly – solve problems – meet deadlines – document errors – support users – develop skills – obtain a certification – update their knowledge – migrate applications

1. IT professionals need to _____ so that colleagues and clients can understand technical information.
2. Development teams must work together to _____ before they affect the final product.
3. Project managers divide responsibilities carefully to help team members _____.
4. After an incident, technicians should _____ so that similar failures can be prevented.
5. Help-desk specialists _____ when they experience login, installation or configuration difficulties.
6. Junior professionals can _____ through internships, training courses and practical projects.
7. Lucía hopes to _____ in cloud technology after completing her preparation.
8. Technology changes constantly, so IT professionals must regularly _____.

GRAMMAR - REVISION

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

In professional IT contexts, we frequently describe:

- Completed events at a specific time.
- Professional experience without specifying when it happened.
- Recent achievements and unfinished tasks.
- Activities that began in the past and are still continuing.

1. Past Simple vs. Present Perfect Simple

Tense	Main use	Common time expressions	IT example
Past Simple	Completed action at a specific past time.	yesterday, last week, in 2024, two days ago, when	Lucía completed her internship last year.
Present Perfect Simple	Experience, recent achievement or action connected to the present.	ever, never, recently, so far, already, just, yet, for, since	Lucía has completed several training courses.

Form

Past Simple

- Affirmative: She joined the company in 2024.
- Negative: She did not join the company in 2023.
- Question: Did she join the company after graduating?

Present Perfect Simple

- Affirmative: She has joined a new development team.
- Negative: She has not joined the certification programme yet.
- Question: Has she joined any professional networks?

Important distinction

- Lucía completed a Linux course last year.
Specific finished time: *last year*.
- Lucía has completed several Linux courses.
Professional achievement; no specific time is mentioned.

ACTIVITY 8 – Choose the correct option.

1. Lucía *graduated* / *has graduated* from university in 2024.
2. She *worked* / *has worked* for the cloud services provider since January.
3. The company *offered* / *has offered* her an internship last summer.
4. The development team already *migrated* / *has already* migrated two applications.
5. She *did not obtain* / *has not obtained* her cloud certification yet.
6. When *did you join* / *have you joined* your current development team?
7. Her managers *gave* / *have recently given* her more responsibility.
8. We *attended* / *have attended* a cybersecurity workshop two weeks ago.
9. *Did you ever work* / *Have you ever worked* with cloud-based systems?
10. The support team *resolved* / *has resolved* six tickets so far today.

ACTIVITY 9 – Complete the sentences using the Past Simple or Present Perfect Simple form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Martina _____ (start) her first IT job in 2023.
2. She _____ (learn) several programming languages since then.
3. The support team _____ (fix) the network problem yesterday.
4. I _____ never _____ (use) this troubleshooting tool.
5. Lucas _____ (join) the company immediately after graduating.
6. Our project manager _____ (work) in software development for eight years.
7. The developers _____ just _____ (complete) the system migration.
8. We _____ (not receive) the updated documentation last week.
9. _____ you ever _____ (manage) a development project?
10. The team _____ already _____ (document) the most common errors.

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

2. For, Since, Just, Already and Yet

Expression	Use	Example
for	A period of time	She has worked here for two years.
since	The starting point of an action	She has worked here since 2024.
just	A very recent action	The system has just crashed.
already	An action completed sooner than expected	The team has already fixed the problem.
yet	An unfinished or expected action; normally used in questions and negatives	They haven't installed the update yet.

Position in the sentence

- Just and already normally appear between *have/has* and the past participle.
- Yet normally appears at the end of questions and negative sentences.

ACTIVITY 10 – Complete the sentences with **for, since, just, already** or **yet**.

1. Martina has worked as a software tester _____ 2024.
2. We have been part of this development team _____ six months.
3. The monitoring system has _____ detected a configuration problem.
4. I have _____ completed the introductory Linux course, so I can begin the advanced module.
5. The company has not published the new job description _____.
6. The developers have been working on the authentication problem _____ Monday.
7. The technician has been examining the server _____ three hours.
8. Have you updated your professional profile _____?
9. The team has _____ migrated the database, although the deadline is next week.
10. The manager has _____ received the incident report and is reading it now.

3. Introduction to the Present Perfect Continuous

We use the Present Perfect Continuous to describe an activity that began in the past and is still continuing, or a recent activity whose effects are visible now.

Form

Subject + have/has + been + verb-ing

- I have been studying cloud computing.
- She has been working on the migration.
- They have not been testing the new application.
- Have you been preparing for the certification?

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

Present Perfect Simple vs. Present Perfect Continuous

Present Perfect Simple	Present Perfect Continuous
Focuses on a result, achievement or completed quantity.	Focuses on the activity, duration or continuing process.
She has completed three courses.	She has been studying for four months.
The team has resolved ten tickets today.	The team has been resolving tickets all morning.

State verbs

State verbs such as *know*, *believe*, *understand*, *own* and *need* are not normally used in continuous forms.

- Correct: I have known my project manager for three years.
- Not normally used: I have been knowing my project manager for three years.

ACTIVITY 11 – Simple or Continuous? Choose the correct option.

1. Lucía *has studied* / *has been studying* container technology for four months.
2. She *has completed* / *has been completing* three online courses so far.
3. The technicians *have worked* / *have been working* on the network problem all morning.
4. The support team *has resolved* / *has been resolving* five urgent tickets today.
5. I *have tried* / *have been trying* to fix this configuration error since 9 a.m.
6. Martina *has written* / *has been writing* two technical reports this week.
7. We *have learnt* / *have been learning* Python for six months.
8. The administrator *has updated* / *has been updating* all the user accounts, so the task is now complete.
9. I *have known* / *have been knowing* our lead developer since university.
10. The system *has run* / *has been running* without interruption since yesterday.

ACTIVITY 12 – Complete the sentences using the Present Perfect Simple or Present Perfect Continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

1. The QA team _____ (test) the application for two hours.
2. Sofia _____ (complete) four cybersecurity modules so far.
3. The server _____ (run) without interruption since 6 a.m.
4. Our cloud engineer _____ (configure) three servers today.
5. The developers _____ (discuss) the authentication issue all afternoon.
6. I _____ never _____ (work) in network security.
7. The design team _____ (improve) the interface for several weeks.
8. The project manager _____ (review) all the incident reports.
9. How long _____ you _____ (prepare) for the certification exam?
10. We _____ (use) this monitoring tool on three different projects.

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

ACTIVITY 13 – Grammar in Context. Read the professional profile and choose the correct option for each gap.

Preparing for the Next Career Step

Martín (1) _____ his career as a help-desk technician two years ago. Since then, he (2) _____ with a variety of users and technical problems. He (3) _____ several training courses in network administration, but he has not obtained an official certification (4) _____.

Over the past three months, Martín (5) _____ for an international networking exam. He normally studies after work and has been using online laboratories (6) _____ January. Last week, he (7) _____ a practical workshop on network security. Since the workshop began, he (8) _____ different methods for detecting suspicious activity.

Martín has (9) _____ finished his final practice examination, and his results were better than expected. He believes that the preparation process (10) _____ him more confident and independent.

	A	B	C
1	has started	started	has been starting
2	worked	has worked	works
3	has already completed	already completed	has been completing
4	already	since	yet
5	prepared	has been preparing	prepares
6	for	since	yet
7	attended	has attended	has been attending
8	practised	has been practising	is practising
9	yet	since	just
10	made	has made	has been making

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 14 – Career Experience Interview

Interview your partner using the questions below. Ask the corresponding follow-up question and write brief notes. Answer in complete sentences.

Interview question	Follow-up question
1. Have you ever completed an online technology course?	What course did you complete? When did you complete it?
2. Have you ever developed an application, website or university project?	What did you develop?
3. How long have you been studying English?	When did you start?
4. How long have you been studying Systems?	What subjects have you completed so far?
5. Have you developed any new technical skills recently?	How did you develop them?
6. Have you ever solved a difficult technical problem?	What happened? How did you solve it?
7. Have you completed any professional certifications yet?	Which certification did you obtain? / Which one would you like to obtain?
8. What have you been studying or working on recently?	How long have you been doing it?

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

Language support

Present Perfect – experience

- Yes, I have. I have completed...
- No, I haven't. However, I would like to...
- I have never worked with...

Past Simple – specific details

- I completed the course last year.
- I developed an application for a university project.
- I solved the problem by restarting the server.

Present Perfect Continuous – continuing activities

- I have been studying English for...
- I have been working on... since...
- I have been learning... recently.

Final report

Introduce your partner using at least four sentences.

My partner has completed...

They developed... last year.

They have been studying... for...

They haven't obtained... yet.

ACTIVITY 15 – IT Professional Information Gap

Instructions

- Student A reads Role Card A.
- Student B reads Role Card B.
- Do not show your role card to your partner.
- Ask the six questions provided.
- Answer according to the information on your role card.
- Change roles and repeat the activity.

Fixed interview questions

1. When did you start your current position?
2. How long have you worked in that position?
3. What course or training have you already completed?
4. What professional project did you complete recently?
5. What have you been studying recently?
6. What professional goal haven't you achieved yet?

Role Card A – Junior Software Developer

You are **Alex Rivera**, a junior software developer.

- Started current position: March 2024.
- Completed training: Java Development Fundamentals.

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

- Recent project: developed an inventory application in May.
- Current learning activity: studying Docker for three months.
- Professional achievement: contributed to two software releases.
- Unfinished goal: has not obtained a cloud certification yet.

Role Card B – Technical Support Specialist

You are **Sofía Martínez**, a technical support specialist.

- Started current position: August 2023.
- Completed training: Network Troubleshooting Essentials.
- Recent project: created a technical support guide last month.
- Current learning activity: practising Linux administration for six months.
- Professional achievement: resolved more than 100 support tickets.
- Unfinished goal: has not completed a cybersecurity course yet.

Model exchange

Student A: When did you start your current position?

Student B: I started my current position in August 2023.

Student A: How long have you worked as a technical support specialist?

Student B: I have worked as a technical support specialist since August 2023.

Student A: What have you been studying recently?

Student B: I have been practising Linux administration for six months.

Required answer patterns

- I started my current position in...
- I have worked in this position for/since...
- I have already completed...
- I completed... last month/year.
- I have been studying... for...
- I haven't completed/obtained... yet.

ACTIVITY 16 – Professional Progress Update

Instructions

1. Choose or receive one professional role card.
2. Prepare a five-sentence progress update using the structure provided.
3. Present your update to your group.
4. Your classmates ask the two fixed follow-up questions.
5. Exchange role cards and repeat the drill.

Update structure

Your update must include:

1. **Starting point:**
I started/joined...

2. **Professional experience:**

Since then, I have...

3. **Specific completed event:**

Last week/month, I...

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

4. Continuing activity:

I have been... for/since...

5. Unfinished goal:

I haven't... yet.

Role Card A – Junior Developer

- Joined company: January 2025.
- Professional achievement: contributed to three application updates.
- Specific past event: fixed an authentication bug last week.
- Continuing activity: learning Docker for two months.
- Unfinished goal: has not completed the Docker certification yet.

Role Card B – Help-Desk Technician

- Started position: September 2024.
- Professional achievement: resolved more than 80 support tickets.
- Specific past event: documented a network error yesterday.
- Continuing activity: studying cybersecurity since March.
- Unfinished goal: has not taken the security examination yet.

Role Card C – Junior Data Analyst

- Joined analytics team: February 2025.
- Professional achievement: created four performance reports.
- Specific past event: presented a dashboard last month.
- Continuing activity: learning Python for six months.
- Unfinished goal: has not participated in a major data project yet.

Fixed follow-up questions

After each presentation, the listeners must ask:

1. **How long have you been** studying or practising that skill?
2. **When did you** complete your most recent task?

Model progress update

I joined the company in January 2025. Since then, I have contributed to three application updates. Last week, I fixed an authentication bug. I have been learning Docker for two months, but I haven't completed the certification yet.

LISTENING COMPREHENSION

ACTIVITY 17 – Listen to the interview and choose the correct option.

1. *What is the main purpose of the interview?*

- a) To explain how to solve common cybersecurity problems.
- b) To describe Sofía's professional experience, development and future goals.
- c) To compare university education with online courses.

2. *How did Sofía first gain practical experience in technology?*

- a) By developing a university project with classmates.
- b) By working as a cybersecurity analyst.
- c) By completing a professional certification.

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

3. *What has Sofia done since graduating?*

- a) She has worked for a cloud services provider.
- b) She has created her own software company.
- c) She has returned to university full-time.

4. *Which professional skill has Sofia improved the most?*

- a) Programming.
- b) Project management.
- c) Communication.

5. *What is Sofia's next career objective?*

- a) To become a cybersecurity analyst.
- b) To become a university lecturer.
- c) To manage a cloud migration project.

ACTIVITY 18 – Listen to the interview again and complete Sofia's professional profile. Write no more than four words or a number in each gap.

Sofia's Professional Profile

1. University project: A _____.
2. Year of the university project: _____.
3. Length of internship: _____.
4. Current employer: A _____.
5. Time in current position: _____.
6. Support tickets resolved: More than _____.
7. Applications migrated: _____.
8. Current area of study: _____.
9. Main difficulty: Working _____.
10. Future position: _____.

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 19 – Choose the correct option.

1. Martina _____ her first position as a junior developer in 2024.
 - a) has started
 - b) started
 - c) has been starting
2. Lucas _____ for the same cloud services provider since graduating.
 - a) worked
 - b) has worked
 - c) works
3. The support team _____ the urgent network problem, so the system is operating normally again.
 - a) has just resolved
 - b) resolved yesterday
 - c) has been resolving

Unit 1: Building a Career in Tech

4. We _____ the cybersecurity workshop last Friday because we had an urgent project meeting.
- a) haven't attended
b) didn't attend
c) don't attend
5. _____ a technical team during a university project?
- a) Did you ever manage
b) Have you ever managed
c) Have you ever manage
6. The developers _____ the authentication error during last week's system review.
- a) have identified
b) identify
c) identified
7. Sofía _____ her professional certification yet.
- a) didn't obtain
b) hasn't obtained
c) hasn't obtain
8. Our new technician _____ three training modules so far.
- a) completed
b) has completed
c) has been completing

ACTIVITY 20 – Sentence Transformation. Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first. Use the word given. Do not change the word.

1. Sofía started working in technical support two years ago. **FOR**
Sofía _____ technical support for two years.
2. Martín began preparing for his certification in January. **SINCE**
Martín _____ his certification since January.
3. The development team finished the system migration a few minutes ago. **JUST**
The development team _____ the system migration.
4. The technicians completed the incident report earlier than expected. **ALREADY**
The technicians _____ the incident report.
5. The project manager still needs to review the new documentation. **YET**
The project manager _____ the new documentation yet.
6. I started learning Python six months ago. **FOR**
I _____ Python for six months.
7. The last time we updated the professional profiles was March. **SINCE**
We _____ the professional profiles since March.
8. Lucía finished her final online laboratory a moment ago. **JUST**
Lucía _____ her final online laboratory.

ACTIVITY 21 – Complete the sentences using the Present Perfect Simple or Present Perfect Continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Carla _____ (study) network security for three months.
2. She _____ (complete) four training modules so far.
3. The technicians _____ (work) on the server problem since 8 a.m.
4. Our help-desk specialist _____ (resolve) six support tickets today.
5. I _____ (know) our project manager for several years.
6. The development team _____ (try) to identify the configuration error all morning.
7. The cloud engineers _____ already _____ (migrate) two applications.
8. How long _____ you _____ (prepare) for the certification examination?



TALLER DE INGLÉS

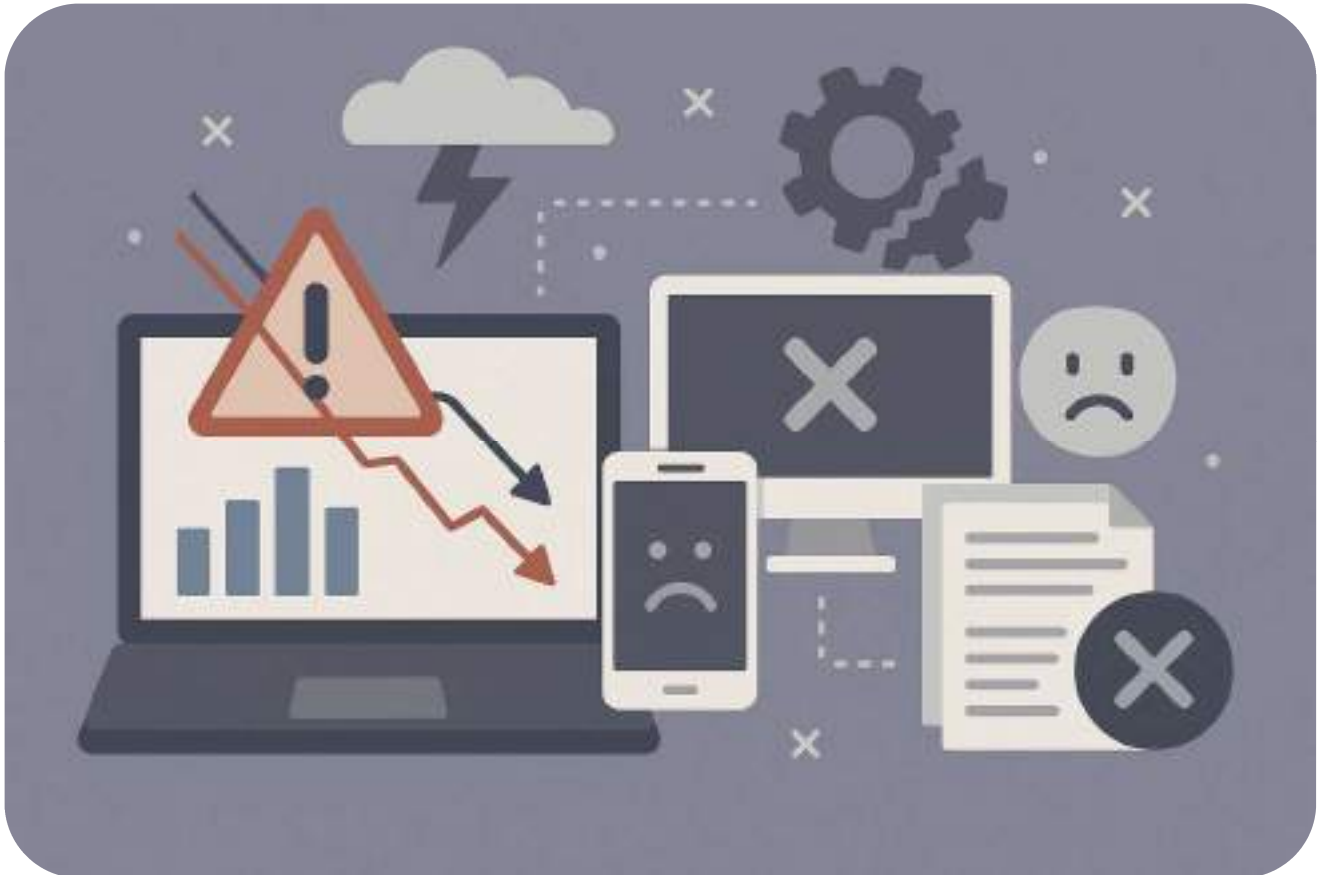
UNIT 2

NIVEL 2

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Unit 2

When Systems Fail



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

- describe technical incidents using appropriate narrative tenses: Past Simple, Past Continuous and Past Perfect.
- explain the chronological sequence of events during a system failure.
- distinguish between completed, interrupted and earlier past actions.
- understand authentic texts describing IT incidents and troubleshooting procedures.
- identify the causes and consequences of system failures.
- use technical vocabulary related to outages, debugging and incident response.
- discuss IT incidents collaboratively using appropriate professional language.
- write a structured incident report describing a technical problem, its causes and its resolution.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

WARM-UP

Activity 1 – Technology Never Fails... Right?

A. Discuss with a partner.

1. Have you ever experienced any of these situations?

- *your computer suddenly froze*
- *an application crashed*
- *your Internet connection stopped working*
- *you lost an important file*
- *a website was unavailable*
- *your phone restarted unexpectedly*

→ Which situation was the most frustrating? Why?

B. Think about IT professionals.

*Imagine you work in an IT department: One Monday morning, more than **2,000 employees** cannot log into the company's internal system.*

→ Discuss:

- What could have caused the problem?
- Who would notice the problem first?
- What should the IT team do first?
- What information would they need before solving the problem?

→ Share your ideas with the class.

Activity 2 – Predict the Story

Look at the title of the reading.

How a Routine Software Update Caused Six Hours of Downtime

→ Before reading, discuss these questions.

1. What do you think the software update was supposed to improve?
2. What kinds of problems can software updates sometimes cause?
3. What do you think "downtime" means?
4. Which people might be involved in solving this problem?
 - Software developers
 - System administrators
 - Network engineers
 - Help Desk technicians
 - Cybersecurity specialists

→ Explain your choices.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT –“Building a Career in Technology”

How a Routine Software Update Caused Six Hours of Downtime *An Incident Review*

Last Tuesday, the IT department at **NovaTech Solutions** scheduled a routine software update for its internal project management system. The update included security improvements and bug fixes, and it was planned for **6:00 a.m.**, before most employees started work.

Before the update began, the systems administrator **had created** a full backup of the production database, and the DevOps team **had checked** all deployment scripts. At 6:05 a.m., the installation started without any problems. While the engineers **were monitoring** the process, the new files **were being copied** to the servers.



A few minutes later, employees began reporting error messages. Some users could not log in, while others were unable to access their project files. At first, the Help Desk believed it was a permissions problem. However, after examining the system logs, the engineers discovered that one deployment script **had overwritten** an important database configuration file.

As more employees tried to connect, the application became slower and several services stopped responding. While the network engineers **were analysing** system traffic, the database administrators **were comparing** the current configuration with the backup created earlier that morning. They quickly identified the root cause of the incident and decided to restore the previous configuration.

Using the backup, the IT team restarted the affected servers and carefully monitored the recovery process. By **12:18 p.m.**, all critical services were available again.

After reviewing the incident, the company introduced two important changes. Future updates would first be tested in a staging environment, and every deployment script would require a second technical review before being used in production.

The outage showed that even routine maintenance can create unexpected problems. However, careful preparation, teamwork, and reliable backups helped the company recover without losing any project data.

ACTIVITY 1 – Reading for Gist: *Choose the best summary of the text.*

- A. The company suffered a cyberattack that permanently damaged its servers.
- B. A routine software update caused a system outage, but the IT team identified the problem, restored the system, and introduced preventive measures.
- C. Employees forgot to back up important files before installing a new operating system.
- D. Network engineers replaced several servers after a hardware failure.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

ACTIVITY 2 – Reading for Detail: *Answer the following questions using complete sentences.*

1. Why was the software update scheduled for early in the morning?

2. What had the IT team done before starting the update?

3. What problems did users experience after the update?

4. How did the engineers discover the cause of the problem?

5. What solution did the team implement?

6. What changes did the company introduce after the incident?

ACTIVITY 3 – True, False or Not Given: *Read the statements carefully. Write **T** (True), **F** (False), **NG** (Not Given). Then justify your answers by quoting or paraphrasing the relevant part of the text.*

Statement	T / F / NG	Evidence
1. The software update was planned several weeks in advance.		
2. Engineers monitored the installation while the update was running.		
3. The outage was caused by a hardware failure.		
4. The company lost important project data.		
5. Future updates will be tested before deployment.		

ACTIVITY 4 – Sequencing the Incident: *Place the following events in the correct chronological order.*

- ___ Users reported error messages.
- ___ The IT team restored the backup.
- ___ The deployment process started.
- ___ Engineers checked the system logs.
- ___ The DevOps team verified the deployment scripts.
- ___ The services became available again.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 5 – Vocabulary in Context: *Go back to the reading text. Match each word from the reading to its definition.*

Word	Definition
1. outage	a. the process of returning a system to normal operation
2. deployment	b. a period when a service is unavailable
3. backup	c. a copy of data used for recovery
4. recovery	d. installing software into a production environment
5. root cause	e. the original reason why a problem occurred
6. staging environment	f. a testing environment that copies the production system

ACTIVITY 6 – Technical Collocations

A. *Match the verbs in Column A with the most appropriate technical collocations in Column B.*

Column A	Column B
1. restore	a. system logs
2. monitor	b. an outage
3. examine	c. a backup
4. deploy	d. the recovery process
5. experience	e. software updates
6. schedule	f. error messages

B. *Complete the following sentences using the correct collocation.*

1. Before making major changes, administrators always _____.
2. Engineers carefully _____ to identify unusual activity.
3. The company decided to _____ outside business hours.
4. Users immediately _____ after the update.
5. During the recovery, technicians continuously _____.
6. Once the issue had been identified, the team _____.

ACTIVITY 7 – Vocabulary in Use: *Complete the incident report using the words below.*

backup – deployment – configuration – recovery – outage - logs

Yesterday our IT department experienced a major (1) _____. During the software (2) _____, one important (3) _____ file was accidentally overwritten. Engineers immediately reviewed the system (4) _____ before restoring the latest (5) _____. The (6) _____ process took approximately six hours.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

GRAMMAR FOCUS

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

In professional IT environments, people often need to describe technical incidents clearly and accurately. To explain what happened during a system failure, they frequently:

- describe the main events of an incident.
- explain actions that were in progress when another event occurred.
- refer to actions that had already happened before the main incident.
- present events in chronological order when writing incident reports or troubleshooting documentation.

Narrative tenses help IT professionals explain **what happened**, **what was happening**, and **what had happened** before another event.

1. Past Simple, Past Continuous and Past Perfect

<i>Tense</i>	Main use	Common time expressions	IT Example
Past Simple	Completed actions and the main events in a narrative.	yesterday, last night, at 7:00 a.m., after, then, finally	The update started at 6:05 a.m.
Past Continuous	Actions that were in progress at a particular moment or interrupted by another action.	while, as, at that moment	Engineers were monitoring the servers when users reported errors.
Past Perfect	Actions completed before another action in the past.	before, after, already, by the time	The administrator had created a backup before the deployment began .

→ Form

Past Simple

Affirmative

- The engineers **restored** the servers.

Negative

- The engineers **did not restore** the servers immediately.

Question

- **Did** the engineers **restore** the servers?

Past Continuous

Affirmative

- The engineers **were monitoring** the deployment.

Negative

- The engineers **were not monitoring** the network traffic.

Question

- **Were** the engineers **monitoring** the servers?

Past Perfect

Affirmative

- The DevOps team **had checked** the deployment scripts.

Negative

- The team **had not tested** the update in a staging environment.

Question

- **Had** the engineers **identified** the root cause before restoring the backup?

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

→ Understanding the Difference

Past Simple

Describes the **main events** of the incident.

Users reported error messages.

Past Continuous

Describes **background actions** or actions already in progress.

While the engineers were monitoring the servers, employees began reporting login failures.

Past Perfect

Describes **the earliest action**, completed before another event.

The systems administrator had created a backup before the update started.

ACTIVITY 8 – Choose the correct option: *Choose the correct verb form.*

1. Before the update **started / had started**, the administrator **created / had created** a backup.
2. While the engineers **monitored / were monitoring** the deployment, users **began / had begun** reporting problems.
3. The Help Desk **believed / had believed** it was a permissions issue before engineers **discovered / had discovered** the real cause.
4. When technicians arrived, several services **stopped / had stopped** responding.
5. While the database administrators **compared / were comparing** the configurations, network engineers **analysed / had analysed** system traffic.
6. The company **introduced / had introduced** new deployment procedures after the incident **ended / had ended**.
7. By the time engineers restarted the servers, they **identified / had identified** the root cause.
8. Users **could not log in / had not logged in** because the deployment script **overwrote / had overwritten** an important configuration file.
9. While the recovery team **worked / was working**, the Help Desk **answered / had answered** support requests.
10. The outage **ended / had ended** after engineers **restored / had restored** the previous configuration.

ACTIVITY 9 – Complete the sentences using the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Before the deployment _____ (begin), the DevOps team _____ (verify) every script.
2. While the technicians _____ (restart) the servers, users _____ (wait) for the services to become available.
3. The engineers _____ already _____ (identify) the problem before they _____ (restore) the backup.
4. Employees _____ (report) connection problems while administrators _____ (monitor) the network.
5. After the team _____ (compare) the configuration files, they _____ (discover) the overwritten settings.
6. The company _____ (introduce) a staging environment because a previous deployment _____ (cause) a major outage.
7. When the incident _____ (occur), several engineers _____ (attend) another meeting.
8. Before users _____ (notice) the slowdown, the monitoring system _____ already _____ (detect) unusual activity.
9. While one group _____ (analyse) the logs, another team _____ (prepare) the recovery process.
10. The outage _____ (finish) once engineers _____ (restore) the correct configuration.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

2. Sequencing Events in Technical Incident Reports

When describing technical incidents, engineers use sequencing expressions to explain the order of events clearly.

Expression	Use	Example
before	earlier action	The backup was created before the deployment began.
after	later action	After the engineers analysed the logs, they identified the problem.
while	simultaneous actions	While the servers were restarting, technicians monitored the recovery.
when	one action interrupts another	Users reported errors when the update reached the database servers.
once	immediately after completion	Once the configuration was restored, the services became available.
by the time	emphasizes an earlier completed action	By the time users called the Help Desk, engineers had already identified the issue.

ACTIVITY 10 – Complete with a Sequencing Expression: *Complete the sentences with: **before • after • while • when • once • by the time***

- _____ the update began, the administrator had created a full backup.
- _____ engineers were reviewing the logs, the Help Desk continued answering support requests.
- _____ the deployment finished, users immediately reported login problems.
- _____ the recovery process was complete, all critical services became available again.
- _____ technicians restarted the servers, they verified the database configuration.
- _____ employees contacted the Help Desk, engineers had already detected the root cause.
- The application became slower _____ more users tried to connect.
- _____ the configuration had been restored, the monitoring system confirmed normal performance.
- Engineers documented the incident _____ the services had returned to normal.
- _____ the investigation was completed; the company updated its deployment procedures.

ACTIVITY 11 – Grammar in Context: *Complete the Incident Timeline. Read the report and choose the best option for each gap.*

Unexpected Database Failure

Yesterday morning, the IT department (1) _____ a routine software update before employees arrived. The systems administrator (2) _____ a complete backup before the installation began.

While the engineers (3) _____ the deployment, users suddenly (4) _____ reporting login failures. At first, the Help Desk believed the issue was related to user permissions. However, by the time the engineers reviewed the system logs, they (5) _____ the overwritten configuration file.

Once the administrators (6) _____ the previous configuration, the affected services gradually became available again. After the incident, the company (7) _____ a new deployment policy requiring every update to be tested in a staging environment.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

- | | | | |
|----|---------------|--------------------|---------------------|
| 1. | a) started | b) was starting | c) had started |
| 2. | a) created | b) had created | c) was creating |
| 3. | a) monitored | b) were monitoring | c) had monitored |
| 4. | a) began | b) had begun | c) were beginning |
| 5. | a) identified | b) had identified | c) were identifying |
| 6. | a) restored | b) were restoring | c) had restored |
| 7. | a) introduced | b) was introducing | c) had introduced |

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 12 – Incident Timeline Information Gap

Instructions:

You and your partner are investigating a system outage.

- Student A receives **Timeline A**.
- Student B receives **Timeline B**.
- Do **not** show your timeline to your partner.
- Ask questions to complete the missing information.
- When you finish, compare your completed timelines and retell the incident together.

Student A – Timeline A

Time	Event
6:00 a.m.	Backup completed.
6:05 a.m.	_____
6:15 a.m.	Users reported login problems.
6:25 a.m.	_____
7:00 a.m.	Previous configuration restored.
7:20 a.m.	Services became available again.

Student B – Timeline B

Time	Event
6:00 a.m.	_____
6:05 a.m.	Software deployment started.
6:15 a.m.	_____
6:25 a.m.	Engineers examined the system logs.
7:00 a.m.	_____
7:20 a.m.	Services became available again.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

→ Questions You May Ask

- *What happened at...?*
- *What did the engineers do next?*
- *What happened before that?*
- *What were the engineers doing at that time?*
- *When did the users report the problem?*
- *What happened after the deployment started?*

Language Support

→ Past Simple

- *The deployment started at...*
- *Users reported...*
- *Engineers restored...*

→ Past Continuous

- *Engineers were monitoring...*
- *Users were trying to...*

→ Past Perfect

- *They had already created...*
- *The team had checked...*

Final Task

- Working together, tell the complete story of the incident using all three narrative tenses.

ACTIVITY 13 – Help Desk Call Role Play

Instructions

Work in pairs.

- **Student A** is a Help Desk technician.
- **Student B** is a Systems Administrator.
- The Help Desk technician calls to report a problem.
- Use the prompts below to complete the conversation.
- Then change roles.

Student A – Help Desk Technician

→ You know:

- many users cannot log in;
- employees started calling fifteen minutes ago;
- several error messages appeared;
- you do not know the cause.

→ Ask about:

1. *What happened?*
2. *What was the IT team doing?*
3. *Had they changed anything before the problem started?*
4. *What should users do now?*

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

Student B – Systems Administrator

→ You know:

- *the team had installed a software update;*
- *engineers were monitoring the deployment;*
- *one deployment script overwrote a configuration file;*
- *the backup has already been restored.*

→ Answer the questions and explain the situation.

Useful Expressions

→ Asking

- *What happened?*
- *When did the problem begin?*
- *Had anything changed before the outage?*
- *What were you doing when users reported the issue?*

→ Answering

- *We had just...*
- *We were...*
- *Then...*
- *After that...*
- *Finally...*

ACTIVITY 14 – Incident Review Meeting

Instructions

Work in groups of three.

Each student has a different role.

- **Incident Manager**
- **Network Engineer**
- **Database Administrator**

→ Read your role card.

During the meeting:

- explain what you did;
- explain what happened before your actions;
- explain what other team members were doing;
- agree on one recommendation for future updates.

Role Card A – Incident Manager

You know:

- users began reporting problems at 6:15;
- you coordinated the recovery;
- the backup had already been created;
- services returned at 12:18.

Explain:

- what happened first;
- what decisions you made;
- what the company should do differently.

Role Card B – Network Engineer

You know:

- you were monitoring network traffic;
- you discovered unusual activity;
- you informed the Incident Manager;
- you helped verify the recovery.

Explain:

- what you were doing;
- what happened while you were monitoring the network
- what happened after you reported the problem.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

Role Card C – Database Administrator

You know:

- the deployment script overwrote a configuration file;
- you compared the current configuration with the backup;
- you restored the previous version.

Explain:

- what had happened before you started working;
- how you identified the problem;
- what happened after the restoration.

Useful Language

→ Describing events

- *First,...*
- *Then,...*
- *After that,...*
- *Finally,...*

→ Narrative tenses

- *We had already...*
- *While I was...*
- *The team decided to...*
- *Once we had...*
- *By the time...*

→ Group Task

Complete the table together.

Question	Your Answer
What caused the outage?	
What actions solved the problem?	
Which action happened first?	
What were team members doing during the outage?	
What recommendation would you make?	

WRITING

ACTIVITY 15 – Writing an Incident Timeline

→ Before You Write

When IT professionals investigate a system failure, they often reconstruct the sequence of events before writing a formal incident report.

Study the notes below:

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

Time	Event
7:30 a.m.	Systems administrator completed a database backup.
7:45 a.m.	Software update started.
8:00 a.m.	Employees began reporting login problems.
8:10 a.m.	Engineers examined the system logs.
8:25 a.m.	Team identified an incorrect configuration file.
8:40 a.m.	Previous configuration restored.
9:00 a.m.	Services returned to normal.

→ **Writing Task:** *Using the notes above, write a 120–150-word **chronological summary** explaining what happened during the incident.*

Your summary should:

- ✓ describe the events in chronological order;
- ✓ include **Past Simple**, **Past Continuous**, and **Past Perfect**;
- ✓ use at least **five sequencing expressions**;
- ✓ explain both the problem and its solution.

Useful Sequencing Expressions

- First...
- Before...
- While...
- When...
- After...
- Then...
- Finally...
- By the time...

Useful Language

Past Simple

- The update started...
- Users reported...
- Engineers restored...

Past Continuous

- The engineers were analysing...
- Users were trying to...

Past Perfect

- The administrator had created...
- The team had verified...

Self-Check

Before submitting your work, check:

- ☐ Did I organise the events logically?
- ☐ Did I use all three narrative tenses?
- ☐ Did I explain what happened before the outage?
- ☐ Did I use appropriate technical vocabulary?
- ☐ Did I include sequencing expressions?

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

ACTIVITY 16 – Writing an Incident Report

→ Situation:

You are a **junior systems administrator** working for **BlueWave Technologies**.

Yesterday, the company experienced a **major network outage** after a routine maintenance operation.

Your supervisor has asked you to prepare a short **incident report** for the IT manager.

Incident Notes

- Maintenance scheduled for 6:00 a.m.
- Backup completed successfully.
- Firewall configuration updated.
- Employees could not access internal applications.
- Network engineers analysed traffic.
- Incorrect firewall rule identified.
- Previous configuration restored.
- Services available again after two hours.
- Company will test future updates before deployment.

→ Writing Task

Write an Incident Report (180–220 words).

Your report should:

- ✓ follow the report structure (below);
- ✓ use formal, objective language;
- ✓ include appropriate technical vocabulary from the unit;
- ✓ correctly use **Past Simple, Past Continuous, and Past Perfect**;
- ✓ end with at least two recommendations.

→ Report Structure

1. Background

When and why was the maintenance scheduled?

2. Description of the Incident

What happened?

What problems did users experience?

3. Investigation

How did the engineers identify the cause?

What had happened before they discovered the problem?

4. Resolution

How was the issue solved?

5. Recommendations

What should the company do to avoid similar incidents?

→ Useful Expressions

- *The incident occurred...*
- *The maintenance had been scheduled...*
- *While the engineers were...*
- *Users began reporting...*
- *The team identified...*
- *The issue was resolved by...*
- *To prevent similar incidents...*

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 17 – Choose the correct option.

Choose the best answer

1. Before the software update _____, the systems administrator _____ a full database backup.
 - a) started / created
 - b) had started / created
 - c) started / had created
2. While the engineers _____ the deployment, users suddenly _____ reporting login problems.
 - a) monitored / began
 - b) were monitoring / began
 - c) had monitored / were beginning
3. By the time the Help Desk contacted the DevOps team, the engineers _____ the root cause.
 - a) identified
 - b) had identified
 - c) were identifying
4. The application became slower while more employees _____ to connect.
 - a) tried
 - b) were trying
 - c) had tried
5. The team _____ the previous configuration after they _____ the system logs.
 - a) restored / had examined
 - b) had restored / examined
 - c) was restoring / examined
6. While the database administrators _____ the backup, the network engineers _____ system traffic.
 - a) compared / monitored
 - b) were comparing / were monitoring
 - c) had compared / monitored
7. The deployment script _____ an important configuration file before anyone noticed the problem.
 - a) overwrote
 - b) had overwritten
 - c) was overwriting
8. Once the engineers _____ the correct configuration, all critical services became available again.
 - a) restored
 - b) had restored
 - c) were restoring

ACTIVITY 18 – Sentence Transformation: Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first. Use the word given. Do not change the word.

1. The systems administrator created a backup before the deployment started. **HAD**
The systems administrator _____ before the deployment started.
2. Engineers monitored the installation while users reported login failures. **WERE**
Engineers _____ while users reported login failures.
3. The company restored the previous configuration. Then the services became available again. **AFTER**
The services became available again _____ the previous configuration.
4. First, the DevOps team verified the deployment scripts. Next, they started the installation. **BEFORE**
The DevOps team _____ the installation started.

Unit 2: When Systems Fail

5. Engineers analysed the system logs. Then they discovered the configuration error. **AFTER**

Engineers discovered the configuration error _____ the system logs.

6. The recovery process finished. Then employees logged into the system successfully. **ONCE**

Employees logged into the system successfully _____ the recovery process had finished.

7. Users were trying to access the application. At the same time, engineers restored the backup. **WHILE**

_____, engineers restored the backup.

8. The deployment script overwrote the configuration file before users noticed the outage. **HAD**

The deployment script _____ before users noticed the outage.

ACTIVITY 19 – Complete the Incident Report: *Complete the report using the correct form of the verbs in brackets (Past Simple, Past Continuous or Past Perfect).*

Yesterday morning, our company (1) _____ (schedule) a routine software update before employees arrived at work.

Before the installation (2) _____ (begin), the systems administrator (3) _____ (create) a complete database backup.

While the engineers (4) _____ (monitor) the deployment, several employees (5) _____ (begin) reporting login failures.

At first, the Help Desk (6) _____ (believe) the problem was related to user permissions. However, after engineers (7) _____ (examine) the system logs, they (8) _____ (discover) that one deployment script had overwritten an important configuration file.

While the database administrators (9) _____ (compare) the current configuration with the backup, the network engineers (10) _____ (analyse) system traffic.

Fortunately, the administrator (11) _____ already _____ (prepare) a backup, so the team quickly (12) _____ (restore) the previous configuration.

By midday, all services (13) _____ (operate) normally again, and the company (14) _____ (introduce) new deployment procedures to prevent similar incidents.



TALLER DE INGLES

UNIT 3

NIVEL 2

Lic. en Sistemas | Dpto. de inglés

Unit 3

Planning the new Release



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

1. identify and use key vocabulary and professional collocations related to software releases, project schedules, team responsibilities, testing and deployment;
2. differentiate between spontaneous decisions, intentions, predictions, fixed future arrangements and activities in progress at a future time by accurately using will, be going to, the Present Continuous and the Future Continuous;
3. use future time expressions such as tomorrow, next week, at this time tomorrow and this time next month to describe release plans and scheduled activities;
4. analyse written and spoken release plans to identify relevant information about schedules, responsibilities, technical risks, product features and expected results;
5. conduct a structured information exchange by asking and answering questions about future plans, confirmed arrangements, launch responsibilities and expected events;
6. deliver a guided professional release update describing planned tasks, scheduled meetings, anticipated activities and predictions with clarity, accuracy and coherence.

Unit 3: Planning the new Release



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT – “Planning the Next Release”

“Turning a Roadmap into Action”

_____ 1) A software release begins long before users click the download button. At NovaApps, a development team is preparing version 4.0 of its task-management platform. The previous update introduced useful collaboration tools, but some customers complained about slow mobile performance. The next release is going to improve speed, add offline access and simplify the notification system.

_____ 2) The product manager, Elena Ruiz, has divided the roadmap into several milestones. The designers are completing the interface changes this month, and the developers are going to integrate the new features in September. The quality-assurance team will begin systematic testing in mid-September. These dates were selected after the team analysed customer feedback and technical dependencies.

_____ 3) However, not every decision is final. The team believes the offline feature will attract more small businesses, but the pricing structure is still under discussion. During the last planning meeting, the finance team requested additional research. Elena has promised that she will present two pricing options next Friday.

_____ 4) The release weekend will require careful coordination. On Saturday evening, the engineers will be migrating user data and monitoring system performance. At the same time, support specialists will be answering customer questions while administrators check server capacity. The work is scheduled in stages because the company wants to reduce service disruption.

_____ 5) The team is also facing an unexpected security issue in the login system. The developers are going to fix it before beta testing begins. Elena thinks the correction will not affect the target date, although the security specialists need more evidence before they confirm the final schedule.

_____ 6) For NovaApps, a release plan is more than a calendar. Every team member must understand the objectives, responsibilities and possible changes. After the launch, the company will collect user feedback and decide which improvements to include in the first patch. The success of version 4.0 will depend on technical quality, realistic planning and effective communication.



ACTIVITY 1 – Predicting from the Title

Look at the title, “Planning the Next Release: Turning a Roadmap into Action.”

Based on the title and your knowledge of software development, what topics do you think the text will discuss? Mention at least three.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

ACTIVITY 2 – Read the text quickly. What is its main purpose? Choose the correct option and justify your answer briefly.

- a) To explain how users can install version 4.0 of a task-management platform.
- b) To describe how a software company is organising its next release and coordinating future activities.
- c) To compare different task-management applications currently available.

Justification:

ACTIVITY 3 – Read the text again and match each paragraph with the most appropriate subheading. There are **TWO extra subheadings** that you do not need to use.

Subheadings

- A. Coordinating Work During Release Weekend
- B. A Security Problem Before Beta Testing
- C. Why NovaApps Is Preparing Version 4.0
- D. The Importance of Shared Responsibilities and Communication
- E. A Roadmap with Clear Development Milestones
- F. A Completed Launch with Positive Customer Feedback
- G. Decisions That Are Still Being Discussed
- H. Instructions for Installing the New Version

Paragraph Subheading

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1 | _____ |
| 2 | _____ |
| 3 | _____ |
| 4 | _____ |
| 5 | _____ |
| 6 | _____ |

ACTIVITY 4 – Read the statements and decide whether they are **True (T)** or **False (F)** according to the text.

- 1. Customers reported performance problems with the mobile version of the platform. **T / F**
- 2. Version 4.0 is going to include a feature that users can access without an internet connection. **T / F**
- 3. The quality-assurance team will begin systematic testing in mid-September. **T / F**
- 4. NovaApps has already made a final decision about the new pricing structure. **T / F**
- 5. Elena is going to present two pricing options next Friday. **T / F**
- 6. Engineers and support specialists will be performing different tasks at the same time during release weekend. **T / F**
- 7. The developers have already fixed the security issue in the login system. **T / F**
- 8. Customer feedback will help the company decide what to include in the first patch. **T / F**

ACTIVITY 5 – Work with a partner. Answer the questions and then compare your answers.

- 1. Why is NovaApps preparing version 4.0 of its platform?
- 2. What are the developers and the quality-assurance team going to do in September?
- 3. What information did the team analyse before selecting the roadmap dates?
- 4. Why has the finance team requested additional research?
- 5. What will the different teams be doing on Saturday evening?
- 6. Why is the release work going to be completed in stages?
- 7. Why have the security specialists not confirmed the final schedule yet?
- 8. According to the text, what will the success of version 4.0 depend on?

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 6 – Go back to the reading text. Match the terms in Column A with their correct definitions in Column B.

Column A		Column B
1. release	___	A. A planned date by which a project should be completed or a product launched.
2. roadmap	___	B. A version of a software product that is made available to users.
3. milestone	___	C. A detailed plan showing the stages, objectives and expected timing of a project.
4. quality assurance	___	D. An important stage or checkpoint used to measure project progress.
5. feature	___	E. The process of checking that a product meets the required standards.
6. pricing structure	___	F. A particular function or capability offered by a software product.
7. data migration	___	G. The method a company uses to organise the prices of its products or services.
8. service disruption	___	H. The process of moving information from one system or location to another.
9. target date	___	I. An interruption that makes a service unavailable or less effective.
10. patch	___	J. A small software update designed to correct or improve a program.

ACTIVITY 7 – Complete the sentences using the expressions from the box. There is **ONE extra expression** that you do not need to use.

analyse customer feedback – collect user feedback – conduct systematic testing – confirm the final schedule – integrate new features – meet the target date – monitor system performance – present pricing options – reduce service disruption

1. Before adding a function to the final version, the quality-assurance team must _____.
2. Product managers regularly _____ to identify common problems and possible improvements.
3. The developers are going to _____ into the platform during the next development phase.
4. During the release window, the engineers will use specialised tools to _____.
5. Completing the migration in separate stages will help the company _____.
6. The finance team has asked Elena to _____ at the next planning meeting.
7. The security specialists need additional evidence before they can _____.
8. The team may need to adjust some activities in the roadmap to _____.

GRAMMAR - REVISION

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

In professional IT contexts, we frequently describe:

- predictions about products and markets;
- decisions made at the moment of speaking;
- previously decided plans and intentions;
- fixed future arrangements;
- technical operations that will be in progress at a particular future time.

1. Will vs. Be Going To

Form	Main use	IT example
will + base verb	Predictions based on opinions	I think the new feature will attract more users.
will + base verb	Spontaneous decisions, promises and offers	The server is slow. I will check it now.
am/is/are going to + base verb	Previously decided plans and intentions	The team is going to release a beta version.
am/is/are going to + base verb	Predictions based on present evidence	The error rate is rising. The system is going to crash .

Forms

- Affirmative: *The company will release an update.*
- Negative: *The company will not release an update.*
- Question: *Will the company release an update?*
- Affirmative: *The developers are going to fix the problem.*
- Negative: *The developers are not going to fix the problem today.*
- Question: *Are the developers going to fix the problem?*

ACTIVITY 8 – Choose the Correct Option

1. The roadmap has already been approved. The team **will release / is going to release** the beta version next month.
2. I think the new offline feature **will attract / is going to attract** more small businesses.
3. “The database is responding slowly.” “I **will check / am going to check** it now.”
4. Look at those warning messages! The authentication server **will stop / is going to stop** working.
5. We promise we **will inform / are going to inform** users about every major change.
6. The company has decided to extend the testing period. It **will run / is going to run** additional security tests.
7. The development team will probably **need / be going to need** more time to integrate the feature.
8. “Who can update the project roadmap?” “I **will do / am going to do** it.”
9. The current test results show that the beta version **will require / is going to require** several corrections.
10. I expect most users **will notice / are going to notice** the improvement in mobile performance.

ACTIVITY 9 – Complete the sentences using the correct form of **will** or **be going to** and the verbs in brackets.

1. Look at the server temperature. It _____ (overheat).
2. According to the approved roadmap, the developers _____ (integrate) the new features in September.
3. “These error logs are difficult to interpret.” “I _____ (help) you.”
4. We believe the new interface _____ (improve) the user experience.
5. The company has decided that it _____ (not delay) the release.
6. “Who can contact the support department?” “I _____ (do) it.”
7. The latest security report shows that the correction _____ (take) longer than expected.
8. I promise I _____ (send) you the updated roadmap this afternoon.
9. The project plan states that the QA team _____ (run) two complete testing cycles.
10. The product manager thinks the launch _____ (generate) considerable interest.

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

2. Present Continuous for Future Arrangements

We use the **Present Continuous** for future activities that have already been arranged, particularly when the time, place or participants have been confirmed.

Form: Subject + am/is/are + verb-ing

- *We are meeting the security team tomorrow.*
- *Elena is presenting the pricing options on Friday.*
- *The QA engineers are starting the final tests at 9 a.m.*

Important distinction

- *We are going to organise a meeting.*
This is an intention or plan.
- *We are meeting the developers at 3 p.m. on Monday.*
This is a confirmed arrangement.

ACTIVITY 10 – Choose the most appropriate Future Form. Choose will, be going to or the Present Continuous.

1. According to the shared calendar, we **are meeting / will meet / are going to meet** the software provider at 10 a.m. tomorrow.
2. Elena **is presenting / will present / is going to present** the pricing options at Friday's confirmed finance meeting.
3. I think the new notification system **is improving / is going to improve / will improve** customer satisfaction.
4. The designers have decided to change the interface, but they have not scheduled the work yet. They **will redesign / are going to redesign / are redesigning** it.
5. The QA engineers **are starting / will start / are going to start** the security tests at 9 a.m. on Monday, according to the agreed schedule.
6. "I have left the technical documents in my office." "Don't worry. I **am bringing / am going to bring / will bring** them."
7. The company has approved the migration plan. It **will replace / is going to replace / is replacing** the old database.
8. The support manager **is holding / will hold / is going to hold** a confirmed staff briefing at 4 p.m. today.
9. Look at the security report. This new issue **will delay / is going to delay / is delaying** the beta test.
10. Users will probably **need / be needing / be going to need** additional guidance after the launch.

3. Future Continuous

We use the **Future Continuous** to describe an activity that will be in progress at a specific future time. It is also used for planned technical operations that will continue for a period of time.

Form: Subject + will + be + verb-ing

- Affirmative: *The engineers will be migrating the data.*
- Negative: *The engineers will not be using the main server.*
- Question: *Will the engineers be monitoring the system?*

Common time expressions

- at this time tomorrow;
- at 8 p.m. tonight;
- during the release weekend;
- all morning;
- while the system is being updated.

Examples

- *At 10 p.m., the engineers will be transferring user data.*
- *During the launch, the support team will be answering customer questions.*

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

- *This time next week, users will be testing the new version.*

ACTIVITY 11 – Future Simple or Future Continuous? Choose the correct option.

1. At 9 p.m. on Saturday, the engineers **will migrate / will be migrating** the user database.
2. The support specialists **will answer / will be answering** customer questions throughout the release weekend.
3. I think the offline feature **will attract / will be attracting** more business users.
4. Don't call Elena at 6 p.m. She **will present / will be presenting** the final roadmap.
5. The system **will send / will be sending** a notification when the installation is complete.
6. While the administrators check server capacity, the developers **will monitor / will be monitoring** the data transfer.
7. The company will probably **release / be releasing** a corrective patch soon.
8. This time tomorrow, the QA team **will run / will be running** the final performance tests.
9. When a user reports a serious problem, the support team **will create / will be creating** a priority ticket.
10. During the finance meeting, Elena **will explain / will be explaining** the revised pricing structure.

ACTIVITY 12 – Complete the sentences using the Future Continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

1. At this time on Saturday, the engineers _____ (migrate) the database.
2. During the launch, the support team _____ (answer) customer questions.
3. The administrators _____ (not perform) routine tasks during the maintenance window.
4. _____ Elena _____ (present) the final roadmap at 10 a.m. tomorrow?
5. The developers _____ (monitor) the authentication system throughout the night.
6. At 3 p.m., we _____ (review) the latest test results.
7. The security specialists _____ (test) the new login system all morning.
8. What _____ the QA team _____ (do) while the engineers deploy the update?
9. I _____ (not use) the staging server at 5 p.m., so you can access it.
10. The company _____ (collect) user feedback during the first week after the launch.

ACTIVITY 13 – Grammar in Context. Read the text and choose the most appropriate option for each gap.

The Final Week Before Release

NovaApps is entering the final week before the release of version 4.0. According to the shared calendar, Elena and the team leaders (1) _____ tomorrow at nine. They have already decided that the company (2) _____ the final launch date after the security review.

Deployment begins on Saturday evening. At 10 p.m., the engineers (3) _____ user data, while the administrators (4) _____ server performance. The latest test results are positive, so the QA team (5) _____ the testing phase on schedule.

At four tomorrow, the finance meeting will already be in progress. The representatives (6) _____ the revised pricing structure. Elena believes that the new offline feature (7) _____ more business users.



Unit 3: Planning the new Release

Throughout launch night, the support specialists (8) _____ customer questions. When a developer suddenly reports a laptop problem, a technician says, “Don’t worry. I (9) _____ you after this meeting.”

This time next Monday, thousands of customers (10) _____ version 4.0.

	A	B	C
1	meet	are meeting	will be meeting
2	will announce	is going to announce	will be announcing
3	will be migrating	are migrating	migrate
4	will monitor	will be monitoring	are going to monitor
5	will finish	is going to finish	is finishing
6	discuss	are discussing	will be discussing
7	will attract	is attracting	will be attracting
8	will answer	are answering	will be answering
9	am going to help	will help	am helping
10	will use	are going to use	will be using

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 14 – Future Plans and Project Arrangements Interview

Interview your partner using the questions below. Ask the corresponding follow-up question and write brief notes. Answer in complete sentences.

Interview question	Follow-up question
1. Are you going to work on a technology project this semester?	What are you going to contribute to the project?
2. Are you meeting any classmates or colleagues to discuss a project soon?	When and where are you meeting them?
3. What technical skill are you going to develop next?	Why have you chosen that skill?
4. What do you think will change in software development during the next five years?	Why do you think this change will happen?
5. What will you be doing at this time next week?	What task will you be working on?
6. Are you going to participate in a software release, test or presentation?	What is your role going to be?
7. Will AI tools change the way developers work?	How will their work change?
8. What confirmed academic or professional arrangement do you have next week?	Who are you meeting or working with?

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

Language Support

Will – predictions, offers and spontaneous decisions

- I think technology will...
- Developers will probably...
- I believe companies will...
- I'll help the team with...

Be going to – plans and intentions

- I'm going to work on...
- We're going to develop...
- My team is going to test...
- I'm not going to participate in...

Present Continuous – confirmed arrangements

- I'm meeting my classmates on...
- We're presenting our project next...
- I'm attending a workshop at...
- We're starting the testing phase on...

Future Continuous – activities in progress

- At this time next week, I'll be working on...
- Tomorrow afternoon, we'll be testing...
- During the presentation, I'll be explaining...
- This time next month, I'll be learning...

Final Report

Introduce your partner using at least four sentences.

My partner is going to work on...

They are meeting... next...

They think technology will...

At this time next week, they will be...

ACTIVITY 15 – Release Plan Information Gap

Instructions

1. Student A reads Role Card A.
2. Student B reads Role Card B.
3. Do not show your role card to your partner.
4. Ask the six fixed questions.
5. Answer according to the information on your role card.
6. Change roles and repeat the activity.

Fixed Interview Questions

1. When are you meeting your team next?
2. What are you going to do before the release?
3. What scheduled activity are you completing next week?
4. What will you be doing during the main project phase?
5. What do you think will happen after the launch?
6. What current evidence is going to affect the schedule?

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

Role Card A – Product Manager

You are **Elena Ruiz**, the product manager for NovaApps version 4.0.

- Next team meeting: Tuesday at 9 a.m.
- Plan before release: confirm the final roadmap and announce the target date.
- Confirmed activity: presenting two pricing options on Friday at 4 p.m.
- Activity during deployment: coordinating the release teams on Saturday at 10 p.m.
- Prediction: the offline feature will attract more small businesses.
- Current evidence: a login problem is going to delay the beta test by two days.

Role Card B – Quality-Assurance Lead

You are **Marcos Silva**, the quality-assurance lead for NovaApps version 4.0.

- Next team meeting: Wednesday at 10 a.m. with the security specialists.
- Plan before release: run a complete security-testing cycle.
- Confirmed activity: starting the final performance tests on Monday at 9 a.m.
- Activity during testing: monitoring the load tests on Thursday afternoon.
- Prediction: version 4.0 will perform more reliably than the previous version.
- Current evidence: the login failure rate is rising, so the team is going to extend the testing period by one day.

Model Exchange

Student A: When are you meeting your team next?

Student B: I'm meeting the security specialists on Wednesday at 10 a.m.

Student A: What are you going to do before the release?

Student B: I'm going to run a complete security-testing cycle.

Student A: What will you be doing during the main project phase?

Student B: I'll be monitoring the load tests on Thursday afternoon.

Required Answer Patterns

- I'm meeting my team on...
- I'm going to...
- I'm presenting/starting... on...
- At that time, I'll be...
- I think the new version will...
- The current results show that... is going to...

ACTIVITY 16 – Professional Release Update

Instructions

1. Choose or receive one professional role card.
2. Prepare a five-sentence release update using the structure provided.
3. Present your update to your group.
4. Your classmates ask the two fixed follow-up questions.

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

5. Exchange role cards and repeat the activity.

Update Structure

Your update must include:

1. Planned objective

We are going to...

2. Confirmed arrangement

We are meeting/starting/presenting... on...

3. Prediction

We think/believe... will...

4. Activity in progress at a future time

At... we will be...

5. Evidence-based expectation

The current evidence shows that... is going to...

Role Card A – Product Manager

- Planned objective: finalise the version 4.0 release plan.
- Confirmed arrangement: meet the finance team on Friday at 4 p.m.
- Prediction: the offline feature will attract new business clients.
- Future activity: coordinate the deployment teams on Saturday at 10 p.m.
- Current evidence: the login problem is going to delay the beta test by two days.

Role Card B – Quality-Assurance Lead

- Planned objective: complete two testing cycles next week.
- Confirmed arrangement: meet the security team on Monday at 9 a.m.
- Prediction: the tests will identify the remaining performance issues.
- Future activity: monitor the load tests on Thursday at 3 p.m.
- Current evidence: the rising server temperature is going to require an additional capacity check.

Role Card C – Support Manager

- Planned objective: prepare the online help materials before the launch.
- Confirmed arrangement: train the support specialists on Wednesday at 2 p.m.
- Prediction: many users will ask questions about the offline feature.
- Future activity: answer high-priority tickets during launch night.
- Current evidence: several help pages are incomplete, so the team is going to finish them on Friday.

Fixed Follow-up Questions

After each presentation, the listeners must ask:

1. What will you be doing during the main project phase?
2. When are you meeting or training your team?

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

Model Professional Release Update

We are going to finalise the version 4.0 release plan. We are meeting the finance team on Friday at 4 p.m. We believe the offline feature will attract new business clients. On Saturday at 10 p.m., we will be coordinating the deployment teams. The current login problem is going to delay the beta test by two days.

LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Activity 17 – Listen to an interview about the final preparations for a software release. Choose the correct option: a, b or c.

1. *What is the main purpose of the interview?*

- a. To compare two software products.
- b. To review the plan for an upcoming release.
- c. To announce a problem with the company's servers.

2. *What does Elena say about the release schedule?*

- a. It is realistic, but one system still needs attention.
- b. It has been delayed because of the finance meeting.
- c. It will be completely changed after beta testing.

3. *What will the engineers be doing during the data migration?*

- a. Answering questions from customers.
- b. Reviewing the new pricing structure.
- c. Transferring data and monitoring the servers.

4. *Why will the team complete the work in stages?*

- a. To reduce disruption.
- b. To attract new employees.
- c. To shorten the security test.

5. *What does Elena predict?*

- a. Small businesses will reject the new feature.
- b. Thousands of users will be using the new version.
- c. The first update will be released before version 4.0.

Activity 18 – Listen again and complete the release profile.

Version 4.0 Release Profile

- 1. Planned release date: _____
- 2. Final beta testing begins: _____
- 3. Finance meeting: _____
- 4. Data migration begins: _____
- 5. Expected migration duration: _____
- 6. Number of engineers involved: _____

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

7. Number of support specialists: _____
8. Main technical risk: _____
9. Feature expected to attract new users: _____
10. Target group for this feature: _____

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 19 – Read and choose the correct option.

1. Elena and the team leaders _____ tomorrow at nine. The meeting is already on the shared calendar.
a) are meeting
b) will meeting
c) are going meet
2. The security logs show several serious errors. The problem _____ the launch schedule.
a) is going to affect
b) is affecting tomorrow
c) will be affecting now
3. “The support team has not received the new instructions.” “I _____ them immediately.”
a) am sending yesterday
b) will send
c) am going send
4. At eleven on Saturday night, the engineers _____ user data to the new servers.
a) transfer
b) are going transfer
c) will be transferring
5. The company has already decided that it _____ a new pricing plan next month.
a) is going to introduce
b) will introducing
c) introduces yesterday
6. We _____ the finance representatives at four tomorrow. The conference room has been reserved.
a) met
b) are meeting
c) will be meet
7. Elena believes that customers _____ the offline feature useful.
a) are finding yesterday
b) will find
c) are going finding
8. This time next Monday, the support specialists _____ questions from version 4.0 users.
a) will be answering
b) answer yesterday
c) are answer

ACTIVITY 20 – Sentence Transformation. Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first. Use the word given. Do not change the word.

1. Elena has arranged to meet the team leaders tomorrow at nine. **MEETING**
Elena _____ the team leaders tomorrow at nine.
2. The company intends to announce the launch date after the security review. **GOING**
The company _____ the launch date after the security review.
3. At ten on Saturday night, the engineers will be in the middle of migrating user data. **MIGRATING**
At ten on Saturday night, the engineers _____ user data.
4. A technician offers to help the developer after the meeting. **WILL**
The technician says, “I _____ after the meeting.”

Unit 3: Planning the new Release

5. The positive results indicate that the QA team will finish on schedule. **GOING**
According to the positive results, the QA team _____ on schedule.
6. We have arranged an appointment with the finance representatives tomorrow at four. **MEETING**
We _____ tomorrow at four.
7. At this time next Monday, customers will be in the middle of using version 4.0. **USING**
At this time next Monday, customers _____ version 4.0.
8. Elena expects the offline feature to attract more business users. **WILL**
Elena believes that the offline feature _____ more business users.

ACTIVITY 21 – Complete the sentences with the correct future form of the verbs in brackets. Use will, be going to, the Present Continuous or the Future Continuous.

1. The meeting is on the shared calendar. Elena and Marcos _____ (review) the release plan tomorrow morning.
2. Look at the number of errors in the security report. The problem _____ (cause) another delay.
3. “We haven’t contacted the server provider.” “I _____ (call) them now.”
4. At midnight on launch night, the support specialists _____ (answer) customer questions.
5. The company has decided that it _____ (not postpone) the release of version 4.0.
6. We have reserved the main conference room because the finance representatives _____ (present) the revised pricing structure at four tomorrow.
7. I think the new mobile improvements _____ (make) the application more attractive to existing users.
8. This time next month, thousands of customers _____ (use) version 4.0.



TALLER DE INGLÉS

UNIT 4

NIVEL 2

Lic. en Sistemas | Dpto. de inglés

Unit 4

Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

- explain basic cybersecurity rules and workplace security policies.
- describe how security incidents can be prevented using Zero and First Conditional structures.
- distinguish between obligations, permissions and advice in professional IT contexts.
- understand authentic texts about cybersecurity procedures and risk management.
- identify common cyber threats and appropriate preventive measures.
- use technical vocabulary related to cybersecurity, authentication and data protection.
- discuss security policies collaboratively using appropriate professional language.
- write a workplace cybersecurity guideline or security awareness notice.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

WARM-UP

Activity 1 – How Secure Are You?

A. Discuss with a partner.

→ How often do you do these things?

Habits	Always	Sometimes	Never
Use different passwords for different accounts.	☐	☐	☐
Update your software immediately.	☐	☐	☐
Enable two-factor authentication.	☐	☐	☐
Save passwords in your browser.	☐	☐	☐
Connect to public Wi-Fi without a VPN.	☐	☐	☐
Check whether an email is suspicious before opening attachments.	☐	☐	☐

B. Discuss.

1. Which habit is the safest?
2. Which habit is the riskiest?
3. Have you or someone you know ever received a phishing email?
4. What should people do if they think their computer has been infected?
5. Why is cybersecurity important for companies?

Activity 2 – Predict the Story

Look at the title of the reading.

Why One Employee's Password Caused a Company-Wide Security Incident

→ Before reading, discuss these questions.

1. What do you think happened?
2. How could a password create a security problem?
3. Which cybersecurity rules do companies usually have?
4. Which IT professionals would probably investigate this incident?
 - Help Desk technicians
 - Cybersecurity analysts
 - Network administrators
 - System administrators
 - Software developers

→ Explain your choices.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT - "When One Weak Password Becomes Everyone's Problem"

Why One Employee's Password Caused a Company-Wide Security Incident

On Monday morning, employees at BrightCore Technologies arrived at work and discovered that they could not access several internal systems. Some users were unable to log in, while others noticed unusual activity in shared project folders. Within minutes, the IT Help Desk had received dozens of support requests.

The cybersecurity team immediately began investigating the incident. After reviewing the authentication logs, they discovered that an attacker had gained access to the company's network by using the password of a marketing employee. The employee had used the same password for both a personal social media account and the company's remote access portal. When another website suffered a data breach several weeks earlier, the stolen password became available on the internet.

Fortunately, the company had recently introduced multi-factor authentication for most employees. Because some departments had not activated the new system yet, the attacker managed to access several internal resources before security analysts detected the suspicious activity.

The investigation showed that the attacker had not stolen confidential customer information. However, several shared files had been modified and some internal services had been temporarily unavailable.

After the incident, the company updated its cybersecurity policy. Every employee now has to complete annual security awareness training. Staff are not allowed to reuse passwords from personal accounts, and they should enable multi-factor authentication whenever possible. Employees also ought to report suspicious emails immediately, even if they are not sure that an attack is taking place.

The IT department also introduced new monitoring tools. If unusual login activity is detected, the system automatically alerts the cybersecurity team. If employees follow the company's security guidelines, similar incidents are much less likely to happen in the future.



ACTIVITY 1 – Reading for Gist: *Choose the best summary of the text.*

- A. A company permanently lost all its customer information after a ransomware attack.
- B. Employees forgot to install a software update, causing all company servers to fail.
- C. A hardware malfunction prevented users from accessing company systems.
- D. A reused password allowed an attacker to enter the company's network, leading to new cybersecurity policies and stronger security measures.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

ACTIVITY 2 – Reading for Detail: *Answer the following questions using complete sentences.*

1. Why were employees unable to access some systems?

2. How did the attacker gain access to the company's network?

3. Why was the attacker able to enter some internal resources?

4. What damage did the attacker cause?

5. What new cybersecurity rules did the company introduce?

6. According to the text, what happens if unusual login activity is detected?

ACTIVITY 3 – True, False or Not Given: *Read the statements carefully. Write **T** (True), **F** (False), **NG** (Not Given). Then justify your answers by quoting or paraphrasing the relevant part of the text.*

Statement	T / F / NG	Evidence
1. The attacker accessed the network through a reused password.		
2. Every employee had already activated multi-factor authentication.		
3. Customer information was stolen during the incident.		
4. Employees are now required to complete cybersecurity training every year.		
5. The company plans to stop using remote access in the future.		

ACTIVITY 4 – Sequencing the Incident: *Place the following events in the correct chronological order.*

- _____ Employees discovered login problems.
- _____ The company introduced new cybersecurity policies.
- _____ Another website suffered a data breach.
- _____ The attacker accessed the company's network.
- _____ Security analysts reviewed the authentication logs.
- _____ The monitoring system was improved.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 5 – Vocabulary in Context: *Go back to the reading text. Match each word from the reading to its definition.*

Word/Expression	Definition
1. data breach	a. a secret code used to verify a user's identity
2. authentication	b. suspicious or unexpected behaviour in a computer system
3. monitoring	c. continuously checking systems to detect problems
4. suspicious activity	d. the process of confirming that someone is who they claim to be
5. cybersecurity policy	e. unauthorized access to confidential information
6. multi-factor authentication (MFA)	f. a set of rules designed to protect an organization's digital systems
7. password	g. a security method requiring two or more forms of identity verification

ACTIVITY 6 – Technical Collocations

A. *Match the verbs in Column A with the most appropriate technical collocations in Column B.*

Column A	Column B
1. enable	a. suspicious emails
2. detect	b. cybersecurity training
3. report	c. unusual login activity
4. complete	d. multi-factor authentication
5. protect	e. confidential information
6. follow	f. security guidelines

B. *Complete the following sentences using the correct collocation.*

1. Every employee should _____ before accessing remote systems.
2. Security analysts use monitoring software to _____.
3. Staff must _____ as soon as they receive them.
4. New employees have to _____ during their first month.
5. Companies should _____ from unauthorized access.
6. If everyone _____, security incidents become less likely.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

ACTIVITY 7 – Technical Vocabulary Categories: *Place the following words in the correct category.*

password • firewall • encryption • phishing • backup • malware • authentication • antivirus •
vulnerability • update • hacker • monitoring

Security Threats	Security Tools / Measures	Security Processes

ACTIVITY 8 - Vocabulary in Use: *Complete the cybersecurity report using the words below.*

authentication – breach – monitoring – policy – phishing – firewall – malware – guidelines

Last week, our company detected unusual network activity during routine (1) _____.

The investigation revealed that a successful (2) _____ attack had allowed an attacker to obtain an employee's password. Although the company's (3) _____ blocked most of the malicious traffic, the attacker attempted to install (4) _____ on one workstation.

Fortunately, the security team followed the incident response (5) _____ and immediately reset the user's (6) _____ credentials. Employees were reminded to follow the company's security (7) _____ and report suspicious emails immediately. As a result, the incident was contained without a major data (8) _____.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

In cybersecurity and IT workplaces, professionals frequently need to:

- explain what happens under certain conditions.
- describe security procedures.
- give instructions and recommendations.
- express company rules and policies.
- explain possible future consequences of unsafe behaviour.

To do this, English commonly uses:

- **Zero Conditional** for facts, procedures and rules.
- **First Conditional** for likely future situations and consequences.
- **Modal expressions** to express obligation, permission and advice.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

SECTION A. ZERO AND FIRST CONDITIONAL (REVIEW)

Conditional	Main Use	Structure	IT Example
Zero Conditional	Facts, routines, procedures and general truths.	If + Present Simple, Present Simple	If users enter the wrong password three times, the account is automatically locked.
First Conditional	Likely future situations and their consequences.	If + Present Simple, will + base verb	If your account gets hacked, the company will contact you as soon as possible.

Using when and unless in Conditional Sentences

Besides **if**, English frequently uses **when** and **unless** to describe conditions, especially in technical documentation, cybersecurity policies, and operating procedures.

Conjunction	Main Use	IT Example
WHEN	Refers to a condition that is expected or certain to happen.	When the system detects suspicious activity, it automatically sends an alert.
UNLESS	Means <i>if... not</i> . It introduces a negative condition.	Unless users update their passwords regularly, their accounts may become vulnerable.

→ Common Mistakes

✗ Unless users don't update their passwords...

✓ Unless users update their passwords...

Because **unless** already has a negative meaning, **do not use another negative verb** in the same clause.

Word Order in Conditional Sentences

In conditional sentences, the if-clause (condition) and the main clause (result) can appear in either order. The meaning does not change.

→ Condition First

When the condition comes first, use a comma after the if-clause.

- If employees report suspicious emails, the IT team investigates them.
- If the firewall detects malicious traffic, it blocks the connection automatically.
- If users click on a phishing link, the antivirus will display a warning.

→ Result First

The main clause can also come first. In this case, **no comma is used**.

- The IT team investigates suspicious emails if employees report them.
- The firewall blocks malicious traffic if it detects suspicious activity.
- The antivirus will display a warning if users click on a phishing link.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

ACTIVITY 8 – Choose the correct option: *Choose the correct verb form.*

Choose the Correct Option

Choose the correct verb form.

1. If users **click / will click** on suspicious links, the antivirus **will block / blocks** the download.
2. The monitoring system **sends / will send** an alert when it **detects / will detect** unusual activity.
3. If technicians **install / will install** the security update today, the vulnerability **disappears / will disappear**.
4. If the firewall **detects / will detect** malicious traffic, it immediately **blocks / will block** the connection.
5. If users **don't update / won't update** their software, hackers **will exploit / exploit** security vulnerabilities.
6. If everyone **follows / will follow** the company's cybersecurity policy, security incidents **become / will become** less frequent.
7. If a password **expires / will expire**, users **have / will have** to create a new one.
8. If the cybersecurity team **receives / will receive** another alert, they **investigate / will investigate** the incident immediately.

ACTIVITY 9 – Grammar in Context: *Complete the company policy. Read the report and choose the best option for each gap.*

Cybersecurity depends on both technology and responsible user behaviour. If employees (1) _____ the company's password policy, security incidents become much less frequent. However, if someone (2) _____ the same password for different accounts, attackers (3) _____ access to sensitive information.

If the monitoring system (4) _____ suspicious activity, it immediately (5) _____ an alert to the cybersecurity team. If employees (6) _____ a suspicious email, they (7) _____ it immediately instead of opening any attachments.

Finally, if everyone (8) _____ the company's cybersecurity guidelines, the organization (9) _____ much better protected against future attacks.

	A	B	C
1	will follow	follow	are following
2	use	will use	uses
3	gain	will gain	gained
4	detects	will detect	detected
5	sends	will send	sent
6	receives	will receive	receive
7	will report	report	reported
8	follows	will follow	followed
9	will be	is	was

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

SECTION B – OBLIGATION, PERMISSION AND ADVICE

In professional IT environments, employees must follow security policies, understand what they are permitted to do, and know how to give recommendations to prevent cybersecurity incidents.

English uses different modal and semi-modal verbs to express **obligation, lack of obligation, permission and advice**.

Structure	Main Use	Meaning	IT Example
have to	obligation or necessity	It is required	Employees have to change their passwords every 90 days.
needn't	lack of obligation	It isn't necessary	You needn't restart the server after installing this update.
be allowed to	permission	It is permitted	Only system administrators are allowed to modify firewall settings.
should	advice or recommendation	It is recommended	Employees should lock their computers before leaving their desks.
ought to	formal advice or recommendation	Formal recommendation.	Companies ought to provide regular cybersecurity training.
had better	strong advice or warning	There may be consequences if you don't follow it.	You had better report the phishing email immediately.

ACTIVITY 10 – Choose the Correct Option: *Choose the correct answer.*

1. According to company policy, employees _____ complete the annual cybersecurity training.
a) should
b) have to
c) are allowed to
2. You _____ restart the server after installing this patch. It updates automatically.
a) needn't
b) have to
c) had better
3. Only network administrators _____ modify firewall settings.
a) should
b) are allowed to
c) ought to
4. You _____ share your password with another employee. It is a security risk.
a) ought to
b) shouldn't
c) are allowed to
5. The company _____ review its security policies every year.
a) ought to
b) needn't
c) is allowed to
6. You _____ report the phishing email immediately, or other employees may be affected.
a) had better

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

- b) needn't
c) are allowed to
7. Visitors _____ enter the server room without authorization.
a) have to
b) aren't allowed to
c) ought to
8. Employees _____ attend the optional cybersecurity webinar if they don't want to.
a) needn't
b) have to
c) had better
9. System administrators _____ install security updates as soon as they become available.
a) have to
b) are allowed to
c) needn't
10. You _____ create regular backups to reduce the risk of data loss.
a) should
b) are allowed to
c) have to

ACTIVITY 11 – Complete the Sentences: *Complete the sentences with **have to**, **don't have to**, **needn't**, **be allowed to**, **should**, **ought to** or **had better**.*

1. Employees _____ use multi-factor authentication to access the company's VPN.
2. You _____ ignore a security warning. It may indicate a serious threat.
3. Staff _____ install software without permission from the IT department.
4. Technicians _____ restart the servers after this update because the changes are applied automatically.
5. Companies _____ provide regular cybersecurity training for all employees.
6. You _____ report a lost company laptop immediately.
7. Temporary employees _____ access confidential customer information.
8. Users _____ create stronger passwords to improve account security.
9. Administrators _____ review system logs every day to detect suspicious activity.
10. Employees _____ attend the optional workshop if they already completed the online course.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 12 – Company Security Audit

Instructions:

Work in pairs.

- Student A is the **IT Security Officer**.
- Student B is a **new employee**.
- The new employee asks about the company's cybersecurity rules.
- The IT Security Officer answers using the information below.
- After each answer, the new employee asks one follow-up question.
- Then change roles.

→ Employee Questions

1. *Do I have to change my password regularly?*
2. *Am I allowed to install software on my computer?*
3. *What should I do if I receive a suspicious email?*
4. *Do I have to lock my computer when I leave my desk?*
5. *What happens if someone clicks on a phishing link?*
6. *What should employees do to protect company data?*

→ Security Officer's Notes

<i>Situation</i>	<i>Information</i>
<i>Passwords</i>	Employees have to change them every 90 days.
<i>Software</i>	Only approved software is allowed.
<i>Phishing</i>	Report it immediately to the IT department.
<i>Computers</i>	Lock your computer whenever you leave your desk.
<i>Suspicious links</i>	The security team investigates the incident immediately.
<i>Data protection</i>	Employees should encrypt confidential files and use strong passwords.

Language Support

Giving obligations

- Employees have to...
- You don't have to...
- You are allowed to...
- You aren't allowed to...

Giving advice

- You should...
- You ought to...
- You had better...

Talking about consequences

- If..., the system...
- If..., the IT team will...
- When..., employees...

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

ACTIVITY 13 – Risk Management Meeting

Instructions

Work in groups of three or four.

- Imagine your team has been asked to prepare basic cybersecurity guidelines for a small software company.
- Discuss each situation below.
- For every situation, answer the three questions.

Situation 1

Employees use the same password for every account.

- What risk does this create?
- What rule should the company introduce?
- What will happen if employees continue doing this?

Situation 3

A worker receives a suspicious email with an attachment.

- What should the employee do?
- What shouldn't they do?
- What will happen if they report it immediately?

Situation 2

Developers install free software from unknown websites.

- Should employees be allowed to do this?
- Why or why not?
- What could happen if malicious software is installed?

Situation 4

A technician leaves a computer unlocked during lunch.

- What security rule has been broken?
- What advice would you give?
- What could happen if someone accesses the computer?

Discussion Checklist

During your discussion, try to use:

- ✓ at least **three Zero Conditionals**
- ✓ at least **three First Conditionals**
- ✓ **have to**
- ✓ **be allowed to**
- ✓ **should**
- ✓ **had better**

Language Support

Making rules

- Employees have to...
- Employees aren't allowed to...
- Staff needn't...

Giving advice

- They should...
- They ought to...
- They had better...

Describing consequences

- If employees..., the company will...
- If users don't..., attackers may...
- When the system detects..., it...
- Unless employees..., the company will...

WRITING

ACTIVITY 15 – Cybersecurity Guidelines

Situation

You have recently joined the IT department of TechSolutions Inc.

The company is preparing a Cybersecurity Guide for New Employees.

Your supervisor has asked you to **write 8–10 security rules** that every employee should follow.

→ Before You Write

Think about these questions.

- What security rules are essential in every company?
- What should employees do to protect company data?
- What aren't employees allowed to do?
- What happens if employees ignore these rules?

→ Your Guide Must Include

✓ at least two Zero Conditionals

✓ at least two First Conditionals

✓ have to

✓ be allowed to

✓ needn't

✓ should

✓ ought to

✓ had better

Useful Vocabulary

- password
- phishing email
- malware
- firewall
- antivirus software
- confidential information
- backup
- software update
- suspicious activity
- company network
- authentication
- security policy
- encryption
- data breach

Language Support

Giving rules

- Employees have to...
- Users aren't allowed to...
- Staff needn't...
- Only administrators are allowed to...

Giving advice

- Employees should...
- Users ought to...
- You had better...

Explaining consequences

- If users...
- When employees...
- Unless staff...
- The system will...
- The IT department will...

→ Suggested Structure

- Title: “Cybersecurity Guidelines for New Employees”
- Introduction (1–2 sentences): Explain why cybersecurity rules are important.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

Example:

Every employee plays an important role in protecting company information. Following these rules helps prevent security incidents and protects our systems.

- Security Rules (8–10 bullet points)

Example structure

- *Employees have to...*
- *Users aren't allowed to...*
- *Staff should...*
- *If employees..., ...*
- *When the system..., ...*
- *Unless users..., ...*

	Self-Check Before submitting your work, check that: ☐ I used all the required grammar. ☐ I included cybersecurity vocabulary. ☐ My rules are realistic. ☐ I used complete sentences. ☐ I checked spelling and punctuation.

ACTIVITY 16 – Internal Security Email

Situation

Last week, several employees clicked on a phishing email. Fortunately, the IT department prevented a major cybersecurity incident. Your manager asks you to **write an internal email reminding employees about safe online behaviour**.

→ Write 120–150 words.

Your Email Should Include

- 1. Introduction:** Explain why you are writing.
- 2. Reminder of the incident:** Briefly explain what happened.

Example ideas

- *A phishing email was received.*
- *Some employees opened the message.*
- *The IT department solved the problem quickly.*

- 3. Security Recommendations:** Explain what employees should do.

Include examples such as:

- changing passwords
- reporting suspicious emails
- updating software
- protecting confidential information

- 4. Possible Consequences:** Explain what may happen if employees ignore security procedures.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

Grammar Requirements

Use:

- ✓ at least two First Conditionals
- ✓ one Zero Conditional
- ✓ have to
- ✓ should
- ✓ had better
- ✓ be allowed to

Useful Expressions

Opening

- Dear colleagues,
- We would like to remind everyone that...
- Following last week's security incident...

Giving advice

- Please remember to...
- Employees should...
- You have to...
- You aren't allowed to...
- You had better...

Explaining consequences

- If you receive...
- If employees don't...
- When the system detects...
- Unless you...

Closing

- Thank you for your cooperation.
- Please contact the IT department if you have any questions.
- Together we can keep our systems secure.

Planning Box

Before writing, answer these questions.

1. What security incident happened?

2. What advice will you give?

3. What rules will you remind employees about?

4. What could happen if the rules are ignored?

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 17 – Choose the correct option.

Choose the best answer

- If employees _____ suspicious emails, the IT department can investigate them quickly.
 - report
 - will report
 - reported
- You _____ share your password with anyone in the company.
 - are allowed to
 - shouldn't
 - needn't
- If a firewall _____ suspicious traffic, it automatically blocks the connection.
 - detected
 - detects
 - will detect
- Employees _____ complete the cybersecurity awareness course before accessing company systems.
 - needn't
 - ought
 - have to
- If users don't update their software, attackers _____ known vulnerabilities.
 - exploit
 - will exploit
 - exploited
- Only system administrators _____ modify firewall settings.
 - should
 - are allowed to
 - had better
- You _____ ignore repeated security warnings. They may indicate a serious problem.
 - needn't
 - had better not
 - are allowed to
- If an employee receives a phishing email, they _____ report it immediately.
 - should
 - are allowing to
 - have reported
- Users _____ restart their computers after every automatic security update.
 - don't have to
 - have to
 - had better
- If the monitoring system detects unusual activity, it _____ an alert to the security team.
 - sent
 - will send
 - sends

ACTIVITY 18 – Sentence Transformation: Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first. Use the word given. Do not change the word.

- Employees must complete cybersecurity training every year. **HAVE TO**
Employees _____ every year.
- It isn't necessary to restart the computer after this update. **NEEDN'T**
You _____ after this update.
- Only administrators can install software. **ALLOWED**
Only administrators _____ software.
- If users don't create strong passwords, hackers may access their accounts. **UNLESS**
Hackers may access users' accounts _____ strong passwords.

Unit 4: Cybersecurity Rules & Risk Management

5. Report suspicious emails immediately. It is the best thing to do. **SHOULD**

You _____ suspicious emails immediately.

6. Don't ignore antivirus warnings. **HAD BETTER**

You _____ antivirus warnings.

7. The firewall blocks suspicious connections whenever it detects malicious traffic. **IF**

The firewall _____ malicious traffic.

8. Employees must not use personal USB drives on company computers. **ALLOWED**

Employees _____ personal USB drives on company computers.

ACTIVITY 19 – Cybersecurity Policy Quiz: *Complete the company cybersecurity policy using the correct option.*

Company Security Policy

All employees (1) _____ complete the annual cybersecurity awareness course before receiving access to company systems.

If employees (2) _____ suspicious emails, they should report them immediately to the IT department.

Staff members (3) _____ install software unless it has been approved by the Systems Administration team.

If the antivirus software (4) _____ malicious activity, it automatically isolates the affected device.

Employees (5) _____ use the same password for multiple accounts because this increases security risks.

If confidential information is shared without authorization, the company (6) _____ investigate the incident immediately.

Before leaving the office, employees (7) _____ lock their computers to prevent unauthorized access.

If everyone follows the company's security procedures, cybersecurity incidents (8) _____ much less likely.

Options

1.

- a) should
- b) have to
- c) needn't

2.

- a) received
- b) will receive
- c) receive

3.

- a) had better
- b) don't have to
- c) aren't allowed to

4.

- a) detected
- b) detects
- c) will detect

5.

- a) should
- b) are allowed to
- c) needn't

6.

- a) investigates
- b) will investigate
- c) investigated

7.

- a) ought to
- b) are allowed to
- c) needn't

8.

- a) become
- b) will become
- c) bec



TALLER DE INGLES

UNIT 5

NIVEL 2

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Unit 5

Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

1. identify and use key vocabulary and professional collocations related to software releases, project schedules, team responsibilities, testing and deployment;
2. differentiate between spontaneous decisions, intentions, predictions, fixed future arrangements and activities in progress at a future time by accurately using will, be going to, the Present Continuous and the Future Continuous;
3. use future time expressions such as tomorrow, next week, at this time tomorrow and this time next month to describe release plans and scheduled activities;
4. analyse written and spoken release plans to identify relevant information about schedules, responsibilities, technical risks, product features and expected results;
5. conduct a structured information exchange by asking and answering questions about future plans, confirmed arrangements, launch responsibilities and expected events;
6. deliver a guided professional release update describing planned tasks, scheduled meetings, anticipated activities and predictions with clarity, accuracy and coherence.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT – “Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned”

“When the Backup Plan Failed: Turning an Incident into Improvement”

_____ 1) Two weeks after the release of version 4.0, NovaApps experienced an outage during a database update. At 11:20 p.m., the main server stopped responding, and the monitoring platform sent alerts. The engineers began a rollback. They expected to restore the backup in twenty minutes, but recovery took nearly three hours. No customer data was lost, although clients could not log in or synchronise their files.

_____ 2) During the post-incident review, the team analysed the system logs, configuration records and incident timeline. The direct trigger was a storage permission that prevented the backup server from reading the database copy. Tests had not detected the issue because the test environment used different permissions. Elena explained that the trigger seemed simple, but the outage resulted from several connected decisions.

_____ 3) At first, some engineers suspected a network attack. However, the security logs showed no unusual traffic, so an attack can't be the cause. The backup server must be part of the explanation because every failed request came from that machine. A recent configuration change might also be relevant.

_____ 4) The team then discussed hypothetical improvements. If NovaApps kept its production and testing permissions identical, future checks would be more reliable. If the monitoring system checked backup access every hour, it could detect problems sooner. If the company used a second backup in another region, the service would be easier to restore.

_____ 5) They also considered past alternatives. If the team had tested the recovery procedure after changing the permissions, the engineers would have found the problem before the update. If the documentation had included the correct access rule, the night team would have restored the service more quickly.

_____ 6) The review focused on learning rather than blame. NovaApps decided to align its environments, automate a monthly recovery test, assign an owner to backup checks and update the emergency runbook. Elena concluded that a useful post-mortem does more than explain what failed: it changes what the team does next.



ACTIVITY 1 – Predicting from the Title

Look at the title, “**When the Backup Plan Failed: Turning an Incident into Improvement.**”

Based on the title and your knowledge of IT incident management, what topics do you think the text will discuss? Mention at least three.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

ACTIVITY 2 – Read the text quickly. What is its main purpose? Choose the correct option and justify your answer briefly.

- a) To explain how to install and configure a monitoring platform.
- b) To describe how a company investigated an outage, considered alternative actions and introduced improvements.
- c) To compare the prices and technical features of different backup services.

Justification:

ACTIVITY 3 – Read the text again and match each paragraph with the most appropriate subheading. There are **TWO extra subheadings** that you do not need to use.

Subheadings	Paragraph	Subheading
A. Evidence Against a Cyberattack	1	_____
B. Hypothetical Ways to Reduce Future Risk	2	_____
C. The Incident and Its Immediate Impact	3	_____
D. Why Employees Should Be Blamed for System Failures	4	_____
E. Identifying the Direct Trigger	5	_____
F. Alternative Actions That Could Have Changed the Past	6	_____
G. Turning Analysis into an Action Plan		
H. Choosing the Cheapest Cloud Provider		

ACTIVITY 4 – Read the statements and decide whether they are **True (T)** or **False (F)** according to the text.

- 1. The outage occurred while NovaApps was updating its database. **T / F**
- 2. The company permanently lost some customer information. **T / F**
- 3. The backup server failed because the database copy did not exist. **T / F**
- 4. Previous tests used different permissions from the production environment. **T / F**
- 5. The security evidence confirmed that NovaApps had suffered a network attack. **T / F**
- 6. Every failed request identified in the logs came from the backup server. **T / F**
- 7. The team considered keeping a second backup in the same region. **T / F**
- 8. The post-incident review concentrated on learning and preventing similar problems. **T / F**

ACTIVITY 5 – Work with a partner. Answer the questions and then compare your answers.

- 1. What happened at 11:20 p.m. during the database update?
- 2. How long did the engineers expect the recovery to take, and how long did it actually take?
- 3. What prevented the backup server from reading the database copy?
- 4. Why had the previous tests failed to identify the problem?
- 5. What evidence suggested that a network attack could not be the cause?
- 6. What three hypothetical improvements did the team discuss?
- 7. What two past actions could have helped the engineers avoid or reduce the incident?
- 8. What changes did NovaApps decide to introduce after the post-incident review?

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 6 – Go back to the reading text. Match the terms in **Column A** with their correct definitions in **Column B**.

Column A		Column B
1. outage	___	A. A separate system where changes can be evaluated without affecting real users.
2. rollback	___	B. A documented set of instructions for responding to a technical emergency.
3. backup server	___	C. A period during which a system or service is unavailable.
4. restore	___	D. A chronological record of the events that occurred during a technical problem.
5. storage permission	___	E. A tool that tracks system behaviour and sends notifications about problems.
6. monitoring platform	___	F. To return data or a system to a usable condition by using a saved copy.
7. incident timeline	___	G. A system that stores copies of data so they can be recovered if necessary.
8. trigger	___	H. To return software or a system to an earlier stable version or configuration.
9. test environment	___	I. A rule that determines whether a user or system can read, modify or store data.
10. emergency runbook	___	J. The immediate event or condition that causes a process or incident to begin.

ACTIVITY 7 – Complete the sentences with the correct professional collocation from the box. There is **ONE extra collocation** that you do not need to use.

**analyse the system logs — begin a rollback — restore the backup — identify the direct trigger —
rule out a network attack — detect access problems — align the system environments —
update the emergency runbook — assign an owner to backup checks**

- During the post-incident review, the engineers had to _____ to determine which requests had failed.
- If a new software version becomes unstable, the technical team may _____ and return to the previous configuration.
- Before restarting the main service, the administrators needed to _____ from a secure copy.
- The configuration records and incident timeline helped the team _____ of the outage.
- Because the security records showed no unusual external traffic, the specialists were able to _____.
- A more effective monitoring platform could _____ before the backup server becomes unavailable.
- To make future tests more reliable, NovaApps decided to _____ used for production and testing.
- After introducing new recovery procedures, the company needed to _____ with clear instructions for the support team.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

GRAMMAR - REVISION

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

Grammar Focus 1 – Deduction and Probability

We use modal verbs to interpret evidence and express different degrees of certainty.

Modal	Function	Example
must	Strong positive deduction	Every failed request came from that machine. The backup server must be involved.
can't	Strong negative deduction	There was no unusual external traffic. It can't be a network attack.
may / might / could	Possibility	The configuration change might be relevant.

After these modal verbs, use the **base form** of the verb:

- *must be*
- *can't contain*
- *might affect*
- *could cause*

ACTIVITY 8A – Modals of Deduction and Probability

Complete the sentences with **must**, **can't** or **may/might/could**. More than one answer is possible when the evidence only indicates possibility.

1. The main server is responding to the health checks, so it _____ be completely offline.
2. Every failed request came from the backup machine. That server _____ be involved in the incident.
3. The security records show no unusual external traffic. It _____ be a network attack.
4. The information is incomplete, but the recent permission change _____ be responsible for the problem.
5. The new backup is receiving and storing data correctly, so it _____ be incorrectly configured.
6. The server temperature is extremely high, and its cooling fan is not working. The hardware _____ be overheating.
7. Only one user has reported a slow connection. The problem _____ be local.
8. No account could access the database after the permission update. The new rule _____ be blocking access.
9. The application worked normally in the isolated test, so it _____ be the source of the failure.
10. Several explanations are still possible. The storage service _____ be one of them.

ACTIVITY 8B – Recognising the Speaker's Meaning

Read each conclusion carefully. Decide what the modal verb expresses.

Write:

- **A – Strong positive deduction:** the speaker believes that something is almost certainly true.
- **B – Strong negative deduction:** the speaker believes that something is impossible or not true.
- **C – Possibility:** the speaker believes that something is possible but is not certain.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

	Evidence and conclusion	Function
1	The CPU usage is at 100% and the temperature is extremely high. The server must be overloaded.	_____
2	The database is responding to all the health checks. It can't be completely offline.	_____
3	The problem started immediately after the software update. The new version may be causing the errors.	_____
4	The original file and the backup have identical checksums. The backup can't be corrupted.	_____
5	Every failed request contains the same incorrect access rule. The storage permission must be the source of the problem.	_____
6	Only employees working from home are experiencing the problem. The connection issue might be local.	_____
7	Two independent tests have produced exactly the same error. The bug must be in the application code.	_____
8	The security scan found no suspicious files or unauthorised activity. Malware can't be the cause.	_____
9	One of the network cables appears to be loose, but the technician has not inspected it yet. The hardware could be responsible.	_____
10	The incident records are incomplete, so human error may be involved.	_____

Grammar Focus 2 – Second Conditional

We use the **Second Conditional** to describe hypothetical or unlikely present and future situations.

If-clause	Result clause
If + Past Simple	would/could + base verb

- If the monitoring system **checked** the backup every hour, it **could detect** problems sooner.
- If NovaApps **used** another server, the system **would be** more resilient.
- In formal English, **were** can be used with all subjects:
- If the backup server **were** in another region, recovery would be easier.

ACTIVITY 9 – Second Conditional

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. If the monitoring system _____ (check) backup access every hour, it _____ (detect) the problem sooner.
2. If NovaApps _____ (keep) its production and testing permissions identical, the tests _____ (be) more reliable.
3. If the backup server _____ (be) in another region, the company _____ (reduce) the risk of a complete outage.
4. If the engineers _____ (have) a clearer monitoring dashboard, they _____ (respond) faster.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

5. What _____ you _____ (change) if the same outage _____ (happen) again?
6. If the company _____ (not depend) on a single server, the service _____ (be) more resilient.
7. If the emergency runbook _____ (contain) clearer instructions, the night team _____ (make) fewer mistakes.
8. If Elena _____ (lead) another post-incident review, she _____ (invite) the security specialists.
9. If recovery tests _____ (take) place every month, the team _____ (identify) access problems earlier.
10. If customers _____ (receive) automatic status updates, they _____ (not need) to contact the support team.

ACTIVITY 10 – Choosing the Correct Form

1. If the production and testing configurations were identical, the results _____ more reliable.
a) will be
b) would be
c) would have been
2. NovaApps _____ future risks if it used a second backup region.
a) would reduce
b) reduced yesterday
c) will have reduced
3. Every failed request came from the backup server. It _____ involved in the incident.
a) can't be
b) must be
c) might not exist
4. The security logs show no unusual external traffic. The cause _____ a cyberattack.
a) must be
b) could definitely be
c) can't be
5. The evidence is incomplete, but the configuration change _____ relevant.
a) might be
b) must not to be
c) would have
6. If the monitoring platform checked backup access hourly, it _____ problems earlier.
a) could detect
b) detected yesterday
c) will detecting
7. What _____ if the main server stopped responding again?
a) would the engineers do
b) did the engineers doing
c) the engineers would do
8. If the company did not update the emergency runbook, the recovery process _____ unclear.
a) would remain
b) remained tomorrow
c) would have remained yesterday
9. The permissions are valid and the backup is responding normally. Storage access _____ the current problem.
a) must be
b) can't be
c) might definitely be
10. There are several possible explanations. Human error _____ one of them.
a) must not be
b) may be
c) would being

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

Grammar Focus 3 – Third Conditional

We use the **Third Conditional** to imagine a different past and its possible result. The real past cannot be changed.

If-clause	Result clause
If + Past Perfect	would have + past participle

- If the team **had tested** the recovery procedure, they **would have found** the problem.
- The team did not test the complete procedure, so they did not find the problem before the incident.

Do not use **would have** in the if-clause.

ACTIVITY 11 – Third Conditional

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. If the team _____ (test) the complete recovery procedure, the engineers _____ (find) the problem before the update.
2. If the documentation _____ (include) the correct access rule, the technicians _____ (restore) the service more quickly.
3. If the monitoring platform _____ (send) clearer alerts, the team _____ (react) sooner.
4. If the storage permission _____ (not change), the backup server _____ (not lose) access to the database.
5. If the engineers _____ (begin) the rollback earlier, the outage _____ (last) less time.
6. What _____ NovaApps _____ (do) if the backup copy _____ (be) damaged?
7. If the clients _____ (receive) regular status updates, they _____ (not contact) the support team repeatedly.
8. If the test environment _____ (match) the production environment, the test _____ (detect) the error.
9. If the incident timeline _____ (be) incomplete, the post-incident review _____ (take) longer.
10. If the company _____ (use) a second backup region, the service _____ (recover) sooner.

ACTIVITY 12 – Second or Third Conditional?

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets. Decide whether each situation requires the **Second Conditional** or the **Third Conditional**.

1. If NovaApps _____ (automate) its recovery tests now, future incidents _____ (be) less likely.
2. If the team _____ (automate) the tests before the update, it _____ (detect) the incorrect permission.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

3. If the system _____ (have) clearer alerts, engineers _____ (respond) faster during future incidents.
4. If the system _____ (send) clearer alerts that night, the engineers _____ (respond) sooner.
5. If the backup _____ (be) stored in another region, the company _____ (reduce) its current level of risk.
6. If the backup _____ (be) stored in another region during the outage, the service _____ (recover) faster.
7. If the emergency runbook _____ (contain) the correct rule now, the technical team _____ (follow) it.
8. If the old runbook _____ (contain) the correct rule, the night team _____ (restore) the service sooner.
9. If future reviews _____ (focus) on blame, employees _____ (not share) their mistakes openly.
10. If last week's review _____ (focus) on blame, the engineers _____ (not discuss) the configuration error openly.

ACTIVITY 13 – Grammar in Context

Complete the text with the correct form of the verbs in brackets. Use **must**, **can't**, **may/might/could**, the **Second Conditional** or the **Third Conditional**.

The NovaApps Recovery Plan

NovaApps is continuing its investigation into the version 4.0 outage. The security records contain no unusual external traffic, so a cyberattack (1) _____ (be) the cause. Every failed request came from the backup machine, so that server (2) _____ (be) connected to the incident. A recent configuration change (3) _____ (be) relevant, but the team needs more evidence.



The engineers are now considering future improvements. If the company (4) _____ (keep) its production and testing environments identical, the tests (5) _____ (produce) more reliable results. If the monitoring system (6) _____ (check) backup access every hour, it (7) _____ (detect) problems earlier.

The post-incident review also examined past decisions. If the engineers (8) _____ (test) the complete recovery procedure after the permission change, they (9) _____ (find) the error before the update. If the emergency runbook had included the correct access rule, the night team (10) _____ (restore) the service more quickly.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 14 – Post-Incident Interview

Work with a partner. Ask and answer the eight questions. Give complete answers and use the target grammar whenever possible.

After each answer, ask at least one follow-up question:

- Why do you think that?
- What evidence supports that conclusion?
- What would the result be?
- How would that improve the system?
- What would have happened differently?

Interview Questions

1. What do you think caused the NovaApps outage?
2. Which possible explanation can the team rule out? What evidence supports this conclusion?
3. Which system component must be connected to the incident? Why?
4. What would you change if you were responsible for the NovaApps recovery plan?
5. What would happen if NovaApps used identical permissions in its production and testing environments?
6. How would the company benefit if it kept a second backup in another region?
7. What would have happened if the engineers had tested the complete recovery procedure?
8. How would the incident have been different if the emergency runbook had contained the correct access rule?

Language Support

Deductions and possibilities

- The _____ **must be** involved because _____.
- It **can't be** _____ because the evidence shows that _____.
- The configuration change **may/might/could be** relevant.
- One possible explanation is that _____.

Hypothetical improvements

- If NovaApps _____, the system **would** _____.
- If the company _____, it **could** _____.
- The service would be more reliable if _____.

Past alternatives

- If the team **had** _____, it **would have** _____.
- The engineers would have _____ if _____.
- The incident would not have been as serious if _____.

Partner Report

Report your partner's ideas in four sentences.

1. According to my partner, the strongest deduction is that _____.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

2. They think _____ may/might/could be another possible cause.
3. If they were responsible for the recovery plan, they would _____.
4. They believe that if the team had _____, it would have _____.

ACTIVITY 15 – Recovery Review Information Gap

Work in pairs.

- **Student A:** Use Role Card A.
- **Student B:** Use Role Card B.
- Do not show your role card to your partner.
- Ask the six questions and complete the missing information.
- Student A interviews Student B first. Then, change roles.

Questions

1. What does the evidence show about the incident?
2. Which explanation can be ruled out?
3. What other problem may or might still exist?
4. What would improve the company's recovery process?
5. What would have changed the result of the incident?
6. What action has the company decided to take?

ROLE CARD A – Elena Ruiz, Product Manager

You have the following information:

- Customers could not log in for nearly three hours, but no data was lost.
- The security logs showed no unusual external traffic. A cyberattack can't be the cause.
- The permission change might affect other storage services.
- If the monitoring platform checked backup access every hour, it could detect problems earlier.
- If the company had updated the customer status page sooner, the support team would have received fewer requests.
- NovaApps has decided to introduce a monthly recovery test.

Use these patterns:

- The evidence shows that _____.
- It can't be _____ because _____.
- _____ might still be a problem.
- If NovaApps _____, it could _____.
- If the company had _____, it would have _____.
- The company has decided to _____.

Student A's Notes about Student B

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

Question Student B's information

1	_____
2	_____
3	_____
4	_____
5	_____
6	_____

ROLE CARD B – Mateo Silva, Senior Systems Engineer

You have the following information:

- Every failed request came from the backup server. It must be connected to the incident.
- The database copy was available, so missing data can't be the cause.
- The old emergency runbook may contain other outdated instructions.
- If the production and testing environments used identical permissions, the tests would be more reliable.
- If the engineers had tested the complete recovery procedure, they would have found the access problem before the update.
- NovaApps has decided to install a second backup in another region.

Use these patterns:

- The evidence shows that _____.
- _____ must be involved because _____.
- It can't be _____ because _____.
- _____ may still be a problem.
- If NovaApps _____, the tests would _____.
- If the engineers had _____, they would have _____.

Student B's Notes about Student A

Question Student A's information

1	_____
2	_____
3	_____
4	_____
5	_____
6	_____

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

Model Exchange

Student A: What does the evidence show about the incident?

Student B: Every failed request came from the backup server, so it must be connected to the incident.

Student A: What would improve the recovery process?

Student B: If the production and testing environments used identical permissions, the tests would be more reliable.

Student A: What would have changed the result?

Student B: If the engineers had tested the complete recovery procedure, they would have found the problem before the update.

ACTIVITY 16 – Professional Lessons-Learned Update

Work in groups of three.

Each student receives one role card. Prepare and deliver a professional update of approximately one minute.

Your update must contain **five sentences**:

1. A factual summary of the problem.
2. A deduction or possibility using **must, can't, may, might** or **could**.
3. A hypothetical improvement using the **Second Conditional**.
4. A past alternative using the **Third Conditional**.
5. A lesson learned or confirmed action.

ROLE CARD A – Incident Manager

- Customers could not access version 4.0 for nearly three hours.
- No customer data was lost.
- The security logs contained no unusual external traffic.
- Possible improvement: second backup in another region.
- Past alternative: earlier escalation to the senior engineering team.
- Confirmed action: monthly recovery drills.

ROLE CARD B – Systems Engineer

- Every failed request came from the backup server.
- A permission update had been made before the incident.
- The test environment used different access permissions.
- Possible improvement: identical production and testing configurations.
- Past alternative: complete recovery test after every permission change.
- Confirmed action: automated hourly backup-access checks.

ROLE CARD C – Support Manager

- The support team received 480 customer requests.
- The customer status page was updated late.
- Customer information remained safe.
- Possible improvement: automatic incident notifications.
- Past alternative: status update ten minutes after the first alert.
- Confirmed action: new incident-communication protocol.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

Update Structure

- The main problem was _____.
- The evidence shows that _____.
- If NovaApps _____, it would/could _____.
- If the team had _____, it would have _____.
- The most important lesson is that _____.

Listener Follow-up Questions

After each update, the listeners must ask:

1. Which explanation can you rule out, and why?
2. What would have changed the outcome of the incident?

Model Update

The main problem was that customers could not access version 4.0 for nearly three hours. The outage can't have been caused by a cyberattack because the security logs contained no unusual external traffic. If NovaApps used a second backup region, it could restore the service more quickly. If the team had escalated the incident earlier, the recovery process would have taken less time. The most important lesson is that recovery procedures must be tested regularly.

LISTENING COMPREHENSION

ACTIVITY 17 – Listen to an interview about the NovaApps post-incident review. Choose the correct option: **a, b or c**.

1. *What is the main purpose of the interview?*

- a) To announce the release of a new backup product.
- b) To explain what caused an outage and how NovaApps is improving its recovery process.
- c) To compare the work of the engineering and support teams.

2. *What was the main effect of the outage?*

- a) NovaApps permanently lost customer information.
- b) The complete system remained unavailable for an entire day.
- c) Thousands of customers could not log in, but their data remained safe.

3. *What evidence indicates that an external attack was not the cause?*

- a) The security logs showed no unusual external traffic.
- b) The backup was located in another region.
- c) The engineers had recently updated the emergency runbook.

4. *What will the new monitoring process do?*

- a) Check backup access every hour and send an alert if a check fails.
- b) Reduce the amount of information stored in the backup.
- c) Replace the company's security specialists.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

5. *What is the main lesson from the incident?*

- a) Backup systems are only necessary after a cyberattack.
- b) Having a backup is not enough; recovery procedures must be tested.
- c) Technical documentation is less important than server capacity.

ACTIVITY 18 – Listen again and complete the incident-review profile. Write **NO MORE THAN FOUR WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

1. Date of the incident: _____
2. Time the main server stopped responding: _____
3. Duration of the service interruption: _____
4. Number of customers affected: _____
5. Direct trigger: _____
6. Cause ruled out by the evidence: _____
7. Additional possible factor: _____
8. Frequency of the new backup-access checks: _____
9. Location of the second backup: _____
10. Frequency of complete recovery tests: _____

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 19 – Choose the option that best completes each sentence.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Every failed request came from the backup machine. That server _____ involved in the incident. | a) would be
b) will have been
c) were being yesterday |
| a) must be
b) can't be
c) would have been | 5. What _____ if the main server failed again? |
| 2. The security logs showed no unusual external traffic. An external attack _____ the cause. | a) would the engineers do
b) did the engineers doing
c) the engineers would do |
| a) must be
b) can't be
c) would be | 6. If the team had tested the complete recovery procedure, it _____ the access problem before the update. |
| 3. The evidence is still incomplete. The outdated emergency runbook _____ relevant. | a) would find
b) would have found
c) will have found |
| a) might be
b) must to be
c) can't being | 7. If the documentation had included the correct permission rule, the technicians _____ the service sooner. |
| 4. If NovaApps kept its production and testing permissions identical, the tests _____ more reliable. | a) would have restored
b) would restore tomorrow
c) had restore |

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

8. If the monitoring system checked backup access every hour, it _____ problems sooner.
- a) could detect
b) could detected
c) detects yesterday

ACTIVITY 20 – Sentence Transformation

Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first. Use the word given. Do not change the word.

- The evidence shows that the backup server is certainly connected to the incident. **MUST**
The backup server _____ the incident.
- The security evidence makes an external attack an impossible explanation. **CAN'T**
An external attack _____ the outage.
- It is possible that the outdated emergency runbook is relevant. **MIGHT**
The outdated emergency runbook _____ the incident.
- NovaApps uses different permissions, so its tests are less reliable. **IF**
_____ identical permissions, the tests would be more reliable.
- The company does not use a second backup region, so its recovery process is less resilient. **WOULD**
If the company used a second backup region, its recovery process _____.
- The engineers did not test the complete recovery procedure, so they did not find the problem. **HAD**
If the engineers _____ the complete recovery procedure, they would have found the problem.
- The documentation did not include the correct rule, so the team restored the service slowly. **INCLUDED**
If the documentation _____ the correct rule, the team would have restored the service sooner.
- Imagine that you are responsible for the NovaApps recovery plan. What changes would you make? **WERE**
What would you change if you _____ the NovaApps recovery plan?

ACTIVITY 21 – Complete the sentences with the correct modal or conditional form. Use **must, **can't**, **may/might/could**, the **Second Conditional** or the **Third Conditional**.**

- Every failed request came from the backup machine. That server _____ (be) involved in the incident.
- The security logs contain no evidence of unusual external activity. A network attack _____ (be) the cause.
- The team has not reviewed every document yet. The outdated emergency runbook _____ (be) relevant.

Unit 5: Hypothetical Solutions and Lessons Learned

4. If the monitoring platform _____ (check) backup access every hour, it _____ (send) an automatic alert after a failure.
5. If NovaApps _____ (use) a second backup region, the recovery process _____ (be) more resilient.
6. If the engineers _____ (test) the complete recovery procedure, they _____ (find) the permission problem before the update.
7. If the emergency runbook _____ (contain) the correct access rule, the night team _____ (restore) the service sooner.
8. If future post-incident reviews _____ (focus) on blame, employees _____ (not share) their mistakes openly.



TALLER DE INGLÉS

UNIT 6

NIVEL 2

Lic. en Sistemas | Dpto. de inglés

Unit 6

How Data and Systems Work



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

- explain technical processes using appropriate passive constructions in the present and past.
- identify when the agent can be omitted in professional IT communication.
- understand authentic texts describing software, networks and data processing.
- use technical vocabulary related to data transmission, cloud computing, databases and system architecture.
- explain how information is processed, stored and transmitted.
- describe IT procedures collaboratively using accurate technical language.
- write a clear technical description explaining how a digital system or process works.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

WARM-UP

Activity 1 – How Does It Work?

A. Match the Technology with its Function.

Technology	Function
1. Database	a. stores copies of files in case data is lost
2. Firewall	b. organizes and stores large amounts of information
3. Backup System	c. blocks unauthorized network traffic
4. Web Server	d. delivers web pages to users
5. Cloud Storage	e. allows files to be accessed over the Internet

B. Work with a partner: *Choose two technologies from Activity A.*

→ *Discuss the following questions.*

- What is it used for?
- Who normally uses it?
- Where can you find it?
- Why is it important?

Language Support

- It is used to...
- It stores...
- It protects...
- It allows users to...
- Companies use it because...
- Without it,...

Activity 2 – Spot the Process: *Below are six steps describing how a user accesses a website. They are not in the correct order. Number the steps from 1 to 6.*

Step
☐ The browser displays the webpage.
☐ The server sends the requested files.
☐ The browser requests a webpage.
☐ The DNS server translates the domain name into an IP address.
☐ The user enters a web address.
☐ The browser receives the information.

→ **Pair Discussion:** *Compare your answers with your partner.*

Then discuss:

1. Which step do you think takes the longest?
2. Which devices communicate during this process?
3. What would happen if the DNS server failed?

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT - “When One Weak Password Becomes Everyone's Problem”

How Data Is Stored, Processed and Transmitted

Every day, billions of pieces of digital information are created, processed and shared across computer networks. Whether users send an email, upload a photo or stream a video, data follows a series of organized steps before it reaches its destination. Understanding this process is essential for anyone working in Information Technology.

From User Input to Digital Data

When information is entered into a computer, it is first converted into binary code. This code is processed by the computer's central processing unit (CPU), where calculations and instructions are carried out. During this stage, temporary data is stored in the system's memory so that it can be accessed quickly.

Where Information Is Stored

After the data has been processed, it may be saved on a local storage device or uploaded to a cloud server. In cloud computing environments, files are stored on multiple servers located in different data centres. To reduce the risk of data loss, backup copies are created regularly, and important information is often encrypted before it is transmitted across the Internet.

How Data Travels Across Networks

Whenever a user requests information from a website or an online service, the request is sent through several network devices before it reaches the destination server. The data is divided into small packets, which are transmitted independently across the network. Once all the packets have arrived, they are reassembled and delivered to the user's device.

To improve efficiency, the fastest available route is selected automatically. If one part of the network becomes unavailable, the packets can be redirected through a different path without interrupting the communication.

Keeping Information Secure

Modern computer systems include several security mechanisms to protect digital information. Firewalls are used to filter network traffic, suspicious files are scanned by antivirus software, and user identities are verified through authentication systems. In many organizations, sensitive information is encrypted before it is stored, and access permissions are carefully managed to prevent unauthorized use.

Although these processes usually occur in just a few seconds, millions of operations are performed every time a digital service is used. For this reason, reliable hardware, efficient software and secure network protocols are essential components of modern information systems.



ACTIVITY 1 – Reading for Gist: Choose the best summary of the text.

- A. The article explains how computer hardware is manufactured in modern factories.
- B. The article compares different programming languages used in cloud computing.
- C. The article describes how digital information is stored, processed, transmitted and protected in computer systems.
- D. The article explains why cybersecurity is more important than data storage.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

ACTIVITY 2 – Reading for Detail: *Answer the following questions using complete sentences.*

1. What happens to information after it is entered into a computer?

2. Why are backup copies created regularly?

3. How is data transmitted across a network?

4. What happens if one part of the network becomes unavailable?

5. How do modern systems protect sensitive information?

6. Why are reliable hardware and efficient software important?

ACTIVITY 3 – True, False or Not Given: *Read the statements carefully. Write **T** (True), **F** (False), **NG** (Not Given). Then justify your answers by quoting or paraphrasing the relevant part of the text.*

Statement	T / F / NG	Evidence
1. All files are stored on a single cloud server.		
2. Data is converted into binary code before it is processed.		
3. Packets always travel through the same network route.		
4. Antivirus software scans suspicious files.		
5. Every organization encrypts all its stored information.		

ACTIVITY 4 –Which Stage Does It Describe? *Read the statements. Write the correct stage.*

Statement	Stage
1. Data is converted into binary code.	Stages • Processing • Storage • Transmission • Security
2. Backup copies are created.	
3. Information is divided into packets.	
4. Firewalls filter network traffic.	
5. Packets are reassembled.	
6. Files are encrypted.	

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 5 – Vocabulary in Context: *Go back to the reading text. Match each word from the reading to its definition.*

Word	Definition
1. binary code	a. a collection of connected computers and devices
2. packet	b. a system that verifies a user's identity
3. authentication	c. the smallest unit into which data is divided for transmission
4. encryption	d. the process of converting information into a secure format
5. network	e. the language computers use to represent data using 0s and 1s
6. data centre	f. a facility that contains servers and networking equipment

ACTIVITY 6 – Technical Collocations

A. *Match the verbs in Column A with the most appropriate technical collocations in Column B.*

Column A	Column B
1. transmit	a. data packets
2. encrypt	b. user identities
3. verify	c. sensitive information
4. filter	d. network traffic

B. *Complete the following sentences using the correct collocation.*

1. Routers _____ across the network.
2. Authentication systems _____ before access is granted.
3. Firewalls _____ to block suspicious connections.
4. Sensitive files should be _____ before they are shared online.

ACTIVITY 7 - Vocabulary in Use: *Complete the technical description using the words below.*

authentication – binary code – encrypted – packets – servers – firewall

When a user logs into an online service, their identity is first verified through an (1) _____ system. The request is then converted into (2) _____ and sent across the network in small (3) _____.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

The information is received by remote (4) _____, where it is processed before a response is returned. During transmission, sensitive data is often (5) _____ to protect it from unauthorized access, while a (6) _____ monitors network traffic and blocks suspicious connections.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

1. Passive Voice in Technical Descriptions

In technical documentation, manuals and system descriptions, the **Passive Voice** is used much more frequently than the Active Voice.

The focus is usually on:

- the process
- the system
- the data
- the result

rather than on **who performs the action**.

→ Compare the following examples.

Active Voice	Passive Voice
The CPU processes the data.	The data is processed by the CPU.
The firewall blocks suspicious traffic.	Suspicious traffic is blocked by the firewall.
The system stored the files yesterday.	The files were stored yesterday.

→ Notice that the passive sentence emphasizes the object or the process, which is more common in technical writing.

FORM

→ Present Simple Passive

Subject + am / is / are + past participle

Examples

- Data is stored in databases.
- Information is transmitted through computer networks.
- User identities are verified before access is granted.

→ Past Simple Passive

Subject + was / were + past participle

Examples

- The files were encrypted before they were uploaded.
- The database was restored after the outage.
- Several security updates were installed last night.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

→ When Do We Use the Passive?

We commonly use the passive when:

✓ the process is more important than the person

Data is processed every second.

✓ the person is unknown

The server was attacked last weekend.

✓ the person is obvious

Backup copies are created every day.

(It is obvious that the backup system creates them.)

✓ we are writing technical documentation

Authentication is required before access is granted.

ACTIVITY 8 – Rewrite the Sentences in the Passive Voice

1. The CPU processes the information.

2. Engineers monitor the network traffic.

3. The system stores backup copies on remote servers.

4. The administrator restored the database yesterday.

5. The antivirus software detected the malware.

6. The company installed a new firewall last month.

7. Technicians updated the operating system.

8. Authentication systems verify user identities.

2. Passive Voice in Compound Tenses and with Modals

The Passive Voice can also be used with **perfect tenses** and **modal verbs**.

These structures are very common in:

- technical manuals
- software documentation
- cybersecurity reports
- installation guides
- user manuals

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

→ Present Perfect Passive

Form

Subject + has / have + been + past participle

Examples

- Several updates have been installed.
- The data has been encrypted.
- The servers have been configured successfully.

→ Modal Passive

Form

Subject + modal + be + past participle

Examples

- Files must be encrypted.
- Passwords should be changed regularly.
- Sensitive information can be accessed only by administrators.

→ Agent Omission

In technical writing, the agent ("by someone") is often omitted because it is:

- obvious
- unknown
- unimportant

Compare:

The administrator configured the server.

→

The server was configured.

The second sentence is more common in technical documentation.

→ When Do We Mention the Agent?

Only when the performer of the action is important.

Example: The malware was detected by the antivirus software.

ACTIVITY 9 – Active or Passive? *Read each situation. Decide whether the sentence should be written in the Active or the Passive Voice. Then complete the sentence using the correct form of the verb in brackets.*

1. A user manual explains how data moves through the system.

The data _____ (transmit) through an encrypted network.

2. A technician is describing what they personally did during yesterday's maintenance.

I _____ (install) the security patch yesterday afternoon.

3. A troubleshooting guide explains what happens after a password is entered.

The password _____ (verify) before access is granted.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

4. A project manager explains what the development team did last week.
Our team _____ (configure) the new server cluster.
5. A technical report describes the backup process.
Backup copies _____ (store) in two separate locations.
6. A Help Desk technician explains yesterday's work.
We _____ (restore) the database after the outage.
7. A cybersecurity policy explains company procedures.
Sensitive information _____ (encrypt) before it is shared.
8. A DevOps engineer explains the deployment process.
We _____ (deploy) the new version during scheduled maintenance.

ACTIVITY 10 – Grammar in Context: *Complete the technical description using the correct passive form of the verbs in brackets.*

How Cloud Data Is Protected

When a file is uploaded to a cloud platform, it first (1) _____ (scan) for malware.

The information (2) _____ (encrypt) before it is transmitted across the network.

After the file reaches the data centre, it (3) _____ (store) on several servers to improve reliability.

Backup copies (4) _____ (create) automatically every day.

If unusual activity is detected, security alerts (5) _____ (send) immediately to system administrators.

Finally, all access records (6) _____ (review) regularly to ensure that company policies are followed.

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 11 – Explain How It Works

Instructions

Work with a partner.

- Student A chooses System 1.
- Student B chooses System 2.
- Read your system carefully.
- Then explain to your partner how it works.
- Your partner listens and completes the missing notes.
- Try to use the Passive Voice whenever possible.

→ Language Support

Describing a process

- **First...**
- **Then...**
- **Next...**
- **After that...**
- **Finally...**

System 1 – Cloud File Storage

Read the information below.

A file is uploaded through a web application.

It is scanned for malware.

The information is encrypted.

The encrypted file is stored on several servers.

Backup copies are created automatically.

The file can be accessed from different devices.

System 2 – User Authentication

Read the information below.

A username and password are entered.

The information is verified.

The password is compared with the stored data.

If the information is correct, access is granted.

All login attempts are recorded.

Suspicious activity is reported automatically.

Listener's Notes

System	First	Then	After that	Finally
Cloud Storage				
User Authentication				

ACTIVITY 12 - Explain a Technical Process

Instructions

Work in groups of three.

- Choose one of the following systems.
- Prepare a short explanation (6–8 sentences).
- Use the planning guide.
- Present your explanation to another group.
- After the presentation, answer your classmates' questions.

Choose one system

- Cloud Backup
- Email Delivery
- Wi-Fi Connection
- Software Installation
- Online Banking Login
- QR Code Payment
- Facial Recognition Login
- File Sharing Platform

Planning Guide

Include:

1. What the system is used for.
2. What happens first.
3. What happens next.
4. How information is protected.
5. Where the data is stored.
6. What happens at the end.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

Language Support

Introducing the process

- This system is used to...
- The purpose of this system is to...

Sequencing

- First...
- Next...
- Then...
- After that...
- Finally...

Passive Voice

- Data is transmitted...
- Information is encrypted...
- Files are stored...
- The user is authenticated...
- A confirmation message is displayed...
- Backup copies are created...

Follow-up Questions

The audience should ask at least two questions.

Examples:

- *Why is the information encrypted?*
- *Where is the data stored?*
- *How are users authenticated?*
- *What happens if the connection fails?*
- *Why are backup copies created?*
- *Which step is the most important?*

WRITING

ACTIVITY 13 – Writing a Technical Process Description

→ **Situation:** *You are writing a section of a user manual for new IT interns. Your task is to explain how one technological process works.*

Choose **ONE** of the following:

- How data is backed up
- How an email is delivered
- How users log into a secure website
- How software updates are installed
- How files are stored in the cloud

→ Before You Write

Complete the planning table.

Question	Your Notes
What process will you describe?	
What happens first?	
What happens next?	
How is the data protected?	
What happens at the end?	

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

→ Writing Guidelines

Write **120–150 words**.

Your description should:

- ✓ explain the process logically
- ✓ use sequencing expressions
- ✓ use mostly the Passive Voice
- ✓ include technical vocabulary from this unit
- ✓ be written in formal, objective language

→ Structure Guide

Section	Include
Title	Name of the process
Introduction	What the process is and its purpose
Main Process	4–6 sequential steps using the Passive Voice
Conclusion	Result, purpose, or benefit of the process

Model Structure

→ **Title:** *Write a clear title describing the process.*

→ **Introduction (1–2 sentences):** *Introduce the purpose of the process.*

Useful expressions

- This process explains how...
- The purpose of this process is to...
- This system is used to...

→ **Step 1 – Beginning:** *Explain what happens first.*

Useful expressions

- First,...
- The process begins when...
- Initially,...

→ **Step 2 – Main Process:** *Describe the next stages in logical order.*

Useful expressions

- Next,...
- Then,...
- After that,...
- Once...
- Before...
- While...

→ **Step 3 – Final Stage:** *Explain how the process ends.*

Useful expressions

- Finally,...
- At the end of the process,...
- Once the process is complete,...

→ **Conclusion (1 sentence):** *Explain the purpose or benefit of the process.*

Useful expressions

- This process helps...
- As a result,...
- This procedure ensures...
- In this way,...

ACTIVITY 14 – Writing an IT Knowledge Base Article

→ **Situation:** *You work for the Help Desk of a software company. A new employee has asked: "How is company data protected?"*

- Write a short article for the company's internal knowledge base explaining the security measures used to protect information.

→ Include the Following Points

- authentication
- passwords
- encryption
- firewalls
- backups
- access permissions
- software updates

→ Writing Guidelines

Write **150–180 words**.

Your article should:

- explain how each security measure works;
- describe general procedures rather than specific events;
- use the Passive Voice whenever appropriate;
- include at least three modal passive structures (e.g., *must be encrypted, should be updated, can be accessed*);
- be written in a formal, objective style.

Useful Language

Introducing the topic

- Company information is protected through several security measures.
- Different procedures are followed to ensure data security.
- Sensitive information is handled according to company policies.

Explaining procedures

- User identities are verified...
- Passwords must be changed regularly.
- Backup copies are created automatically.
- Network traffic is monitored continuously.
- Sensitive files are encrypted before...
- Access is granted only after...

Concluding

- These procedures help reduce security risks.
- As a result, company information remains protected.
- Following these practices improves system reliability and data security.

Assessment Checklist (Peer Review)

Exchange your work with a partner and answer the following questions.

Question	Yes	Partly	No
Is the process easy to follow?	☐	☐	☐
Are sequencing expressions used correctly?	☐	☐	☐
Is the Passive Voice used appropriately?	☐	☐	☐
Is technical vocabulary used accurately?	☐	☐	☐
Is the writing formal and objective?	☐	☐	☐
Are modal passive structures used correctly (Activity 18)?	☐	☐	☐

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 15 – Choose the correct option.

Choose the best answer

1. User passwords _____ before they are stored in the database.
 - a) encrypt
 - b) are encrypted
 - c) have encrypted
2. The latest software update _____ last night.
 - a) installed
 - b) was installed
 - c) is installed
3. Backup copies _____ automatically every day.
 - a) are created
 - b) create
 - c) have created
4. Sensitive information _____ only by authorized users.
 - a) can access
 - b) can accessed
 - c) can be accessed
5. Before files are uploaded to the cloud, they _____ for malware.
 - a) are scanned
 - b) scanned
 - c) were scanning
6. The database _____ successfully after the server failure.
 - a) was restored
 - b) were restored
 - c) has restore
7. Security patches _____ regularly to reduce vulnerabilities.
 - a) should install
 - b) should be installed
 - c) should installed
8. Company data _____ on secure servers located in different regions.
 - a) stores
 - b) is stored
 - c) has stored
9. The affected systems _____ by the IT department before employees returned to work.
 - a) repaired
 - b) are repaired
 - c) were repaired
10. Authentication _____ before access is granted.
 - a) requires
 - b) is required
 - c) has required

ACTIVITY 16 – Error Correction: *Each sentence contains ONE mistake. Rewrite the sentence correctly.*

1. User accounts must verified before access is granted.

2. The backup files was stored on a remote server.

3. Sensitive information should encrypted before transmission.

4. The operating system have been updated successfully.

5. Malware are detected automatically by the antivirus software.

Unit 6: How Data and Systems Work

6. The firewall can blocks suspicious network traffic.

7. Several security patches has been installed this month.

8. The files were encrypt before they were uploaded.

ACTIVITY 17 - Technical Documentation in Context: *Complete the technical description using the correct form of the verbs in brackets.*

How Company Data Is Protected

Every employee account (1) _____ (create) by the IT department before a new employee starts work.

Passwords (2) _____ (must / change) every ninety days.

Before sensitive files (3) _____ (store) in the cloud, they (4) _____ (encrypt).

All incoming network traffic (5) _____ (monitor) continuously by the company's firewall.

If unusual activity is detected, security alerts (6) _____ (send) automatically to system administrators.

Backup copies (7) _____ (have / create) every night, and they (8) _____ (can / restore) immediately if necessary.

Recently, several additional security measures (9) _____ (introduce) to improve data protection.

As a result, confidential company information (10) _____ (protect) more effectively.



TALLER DE INGLES

UNIT 7

NIVEL 2

Lic. en Sistemas | Dpto. de inglés

Unit 7

Choosing the Right Technology



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

1. identify and use key vocabulary and professional collocations related to software releases, project schedules, team responsibilities, testing and deployment;
2. differentiate between spontaneous decisions, intentions, predictions, fixed future arrangements and activities in progress at a future time by accurately using will, be going to, the Present Continuous and the Future Continuous;
3. use future time expressions such as tomorrow, next week, at this time tomorrow and this time next month to describe release plans and scheduled activities;
4. analyse written and spoken release plans to identify relevant information about schedules, responsibilities, technical risks, product features and expected results;
5. conduct a structured information exchange by asking and answering questions about future plans, confirmed arrangements, launch responsibilities and expected events;
6. deliver a guided professional release update describing planned tasks, scheduled meetings, anticipated activities and predictions with clarity, accuracy and coherence.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT – “Choosing the Right Technology”

More Than Following Trends

_____ 1) When a software team begins a new project, choosing technology can seem exciting. Developers often want to use the newest framework or database, especially when it is receiving attention online. However, a popular tool is not always the one that best suits the project's real needs. Good decisions begin with understanding the problem that the team has to solve.



_____ 2) This was the situation at MetroLink, a transport company that needed to replace its internal support system. The existing platform, which employees used to report technical problems, was slow and difficult to update. The IT department considered two alternatives: adopting a cloud-based service or developing an open-source solution on its own servers.

_____ 3) The cloud service was easier to deploy and included technical support. It also offered automatic updates, which would reduce the time spent maintaining the system. Nevertheless, its monthly subscription was expensive, and the company would have limited control over where its data was stored. Depending completely on one provider could also create vendor lock-in.

_____ 4) The open-source option, by contrast, allowed the team to modify the software and keep sensitive information inside the company. It had no subscription fee, but using it would require experienced staff. The engineers who managed the company's servers would be responsible for installing updates, solving compatibility issues and preventing security problems.

_____ 5) Instead of making an immediate decision, the team created a proof of concept, which allowed employees to test both systems. They evaluated cost, security, scalability, usability and integration with their tools. They also interviewed the people whose work depended on the platform. This helped the developers avoid choosing features that looked impressive but offered little practical value.

_____ 6) After comparing the results, MetroLink selected the open-source system. Although deployment would take longer, it offered more control and better integration. The team understood that selecting technology means balancing advantages, risks and responsibilities. The best solution is not necessarily the newest; it is the one that fits the organisation's needs.

ACTIVITY 1) Predicting from the Title

Read the title, “**Choosing the Right Technology: More Than Following Trends.**”

What factors should a software team consider before choosing a new technology? Mention at least three.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 2) Skimming: Identifying the Main Purpose

Read the text quickly. What is its main purpose? Choose the best option and justify your answer.

- a) To explain how to install an open-source support system.
- b) To advertise a cloud-based service for transport companies.
- c) To describe how a team compared two technological solutions and justified its final choice.
- d) To demonstrate that the newest technology is always the most effective.

Answer: _____

Justification:

ACTIVITY 3) Understanding Paragraph Organisation

Match each paragraph (1–6) with the most appropriate heading. There is **one extra heading**.

A. Testing the alternatives before making a decision	Paragraph	Heading
B. The risks behind a convenient cloud solution	1	_____
C. Starting with needs instead of technological trends	2	_____
D. The final decision and its broader lesson	3	_____
E. The advantages and demands of open-source software	4	_____
F. A problem that required two possible solutions	5	_____
G. Training employees to operate the new platform	6	_____

ACTIVITY 4) Reading for Detail: True or False

Read the text again. Decide whether the statements are **True (T)** or **False (F)**. Correct the false statements.

1. A technology that is popular online will always satisfy a project's requirements. _____
2. MetroLink employees used the existing platform to report technical problems. _____
3. The cloud-based service required MetroLink's engineers to install every update manually. _____
4. The cloud solution would give MetroLink complete control over where its information was stored. _____
5. The open-source alternative had no subscription fee but required experienced technical staff. _____
6. Only the developers were invited to test the two proposed systems. _____
7. The team consulted employees whose daily work depended on the support platform. _____
8. MetroLink selected the cloud service because it could be deployed more quickly. _____

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 5) - Answer the questions in complete sentences.

1. According to the text, what should a team do before choosing a new technology?
2. What two technological alternatives did MetroLink consider?
3. What were two advantages and two disadvantages of the cloud-based service?
4. Why would the open-source system involve greater responsibility for MetroLink's engineers?
5. Which criteria did the team use to evaluate the two systems?
6. Why did MetroLink select the open-source option despite its longer deployment process?

VOCABULARY

VOCABULARY DIMENSION

ACTIVITY 6) - Match the words and expressions from the reading text with their definitions.

	Word or expression	_____ The process of installing and making a new system available for use.
A	requirements	_____ The conditions, functions or features that a technological solution must have.
B	deployment	_____ A small-scale test created to demonstrate that a proposed solution can work.
C	maintenance	_____ The regular work required to update, repair and protect a system.
D	scalability	_____ The ability of a system to handle more users, data or activity without losing performance.
E	usability	_____ The process or method used to save and protect digital information.
F	integration	_____ A situation in which changing to another technology provider becomes difficult or expensive.
G	subscription	_____ The degree to which a system is easy and practical for people to use.
H	vendor lock-in	_____ A regular payment that gives a customer continued access to a service.
I	data storage	_____ The process of connecting different systems or applications so that they can work together.
J	proof of concept	_____ The process of installing and making a new system available for use.

ACTIVITY 7) Professional Collocations

Complete the sentences with the professional collocations from the box. Use each expression only once. There is **one extra collocation**.

meet project requirements – deploy a solution – maintain a system – improve scalability – integrate with existing tools – pay a monthly subscription – avoid vendor lock-in – store sensitive data – create a proof of concept

1. Before selecting a platform, the team must confirm that it can _____.
2. The developers decided to _____ before investing in the complete system.
3. The cloud provider can _____ more quickly because the necessary infrastructure is already available.
4. A company needs experienced technical staff to _____ on its own servers.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

5. The new support platform must _____ such as the company's database and authentication service.
6. Customers usually have to _____ to continue using a cloud-based service.
7. The team compared different providers because it wanted to _____.
8. MetroLink preferred to _____ inside its own infrastructure instead of depending completely on an external provider.

Extra collocation: _____

GRAMMAR - REVISION

GRAMMAR FOCUS 1: RELATIVE CLAUSES

Relative clauses give information about a person, thing, place or organisation.

Defining Relative Clauses

They provide essential information. Without the relative clause, the meaning is incomplete.

- The platform **that stores the company's data** must be secure.
- The engineer **who manages the servers** is attending the meeting.
- We need a provider **whose support team is available 24/7**.

Do not use commas in defining relative clauses.

Relative word	Reference	Example
who	people	The developer who tested the tool recommended it.
which	things	The software which processes the data is reliable.
that	people or things	We need a system that supports remote access .
whose	possession	They selected a provider whose prices were reasonable .
where	places	This is the server room where the equipment is kept .

The relative pronoun can be omitted when it is the object of a defining relative clause.

- The framework **that the team selected** is open source.
- The framework **the team selected** is open source.

Non-defining Relative Clauses

They provide additional information that is not essential to identify the noun.

- MetroLink's support platform, **which was installed five years ago**, is now too slow.
- Sofia, **who coordinated the evaluation process**, presented the results.

Use commas before and after a non-defining relative clause. Do not use **that**, and do not omit the relative pronoun.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 8A) Defining or Non-defining?

Underline the relative clause. Write **D** for defining or **ND** for non-defining.

1. A database that processes large volumes of transactions must be scalable. _____
2. MetroLink's support platform, which was installed five years ago, has become difficult to maintain. _____
3. The engineer who manages the company's servers participated in the evaluation. _____
4. OpenDesk, which is maintained by an international community, receives regular security updates. _____
5. Teams whose projects contain sensitive information must examine data-storage policies carefully. _____

ACTIVITY 8B) Choosing the correct relative word

1. We need a provider **who / which / where** offers reliable technical support.
2. This is the data centre **where / who / whose** the company stores its backup servers.
3. The engineers **whose / which / where** experience includes cloud migration will lead the project.
4. The test environment **which / who / where** the team created allowed them to compare both systems.
5. Sofia, **who / that / whose** coordinated the evaluation, presented the final recommendation.

ACTIVITY 9) - Combine each pair of sentences. Use a defining or non-defining relative clause and add commas where necessary.

1. MetroLink selected a platform. The platform can run on the company's existing servers.

2. Lucas recommended the open-source tool. He had tested it during a previous project.

3. The company uses DataHub. DataHub is located outside Buenos Aires.

4. Some employees need additional support. Their technical knowledge is limited.

5. The team created a test environment. They could compare both systems there.

GRAMMAR FOCUS 2: GERUND AND INFINITIVE PATTERNS

Some verbs are followed by the **gerund** (*verb + -ing*), while others are followed by the **to-infinitive**.

Verb + Gerund

Common verbs followed by a gerund include: **avoid – consider – enjoy – finish – mind – recommend – suggest**

- The team considered **using** an open-source platform.
- The developers suggested **testing** both alternatives.
- Good planning helps teams avoid **making** expensive mistakes.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

Use the gerund after a preposition.

- The company is interested in **reducing** its operating costs.
- Before **selecting** a tool, the team analysed its requirements.

Verb + To-infinitive

Common verbs followed by the to-infinitive include:

agree – decide – expect – hope – learn – need – plan – promise – want – would like

- The team decided **to create** a proof of concept.
- MetroLink plans **to migrate** its data next month.
- The engineers need **to check** the system's compatibility.

The to-infinitive can also express purpose.

- The team created a test environment **to compare** the two platforms.
- They interviewed employees **to understand** their needs.

ACTIVITY 10) Gerund or To-infinitive?

Choose the correct option.

1. The IT department considered **adopting / to adopt** a cloud-based service.
2. The team decided **testing / to test** both systems before making a recommendation.
3. Using open-source software can help the company avoid **paying / to pay** a monthly subscription.
4. MetroLink needs **improving / to improve** the reliability of its support platform.
5. The project manager suggested **interviewing / to interview** the employees who used the existing system.

ACTIVITY 11) - Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Developers should avoid _____ the newest tool without evaluating it first. (*choose*)
2. The IT manager agreed _____ the final decision until the tests were complete. (*postpone*)
3. The company is interested in _____ its operating costs. (*reduce*)
4. The engineers plan _____ the new system in a controlled environment. (*install*)
5. The team created a proof of concept _____ the two alternatives under realistic conditions. (*compare*)

GRAMMAR FOCUS 3: COMPARING, CONTRASTING AND JUSTIFYING CHOICES

Use the following structures when evaluating technological alternatives.

Function	Structures	Example
Similarity	both...and, similarly	Both systems offer remote access.
Contrast	while, whereas, unlike, however	The cloud service is easier to deploy, whereas the open-source system offers more control.
Reason	because, since	The team selected the tool because it met the security requirements.
Result	so, therefore	The subscription was expensive; therefore , the team examined the long-term cost.
Justification	The main reason is that...	The main reason is that the system can integrate with existing tools.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 12) - Choose the most appropriate option.

1. **Both / Unlike / However** the cloud service and the open-source system can integrate with the company's database.
2. The cloud service is faster to deploy, **because / whereas / therefore** the open-source solution offers greater control.
3. **Unlike / Both / Since** the cloud service, the open-source platform does not require a monthly subscription.
4. The team chose the open-source system **because / however / whereas** it met the company's security requirements.
5. The subscription was expensive; **therefore / unlike / while**, the team analysed the long-term cost carefully.

ACTIVITY 12B) - Rewrite each pair of sentences as one sentence. Use the word in brackets without changing it.

1. The cloud service is easier to deploy. The open-source platform offers greater control. (**WHEREAS**)

2. The cloud service supports remote access. The open-source platform also supports remote access. (**BOTH**)

3. The cloud service requires a monthly subscription. The open-source platform has no subscription fee. (**UNLIKE**)

4. The team selected the open-source system. It met the company's security requirements. (**BECAUSE**)

5. The cloud service included technical support. Its long-term cost was too high. (**HOWEVER**)

6. The platform could integrate with the existing database. For this reason, the team recommended it. (**THEREFORE**)

ACTIVITY 13) Grammar in Context

Choose the correct option for each gap.

The IT team needed a platform (1) _____ could integrate with the company's existing systems. They considered (2) _____ two different solutions: a cloud-based service and an open-source platform. The cloud service, (3) _____ included technical support and automatic updates, was easier to deploy. The open-source platform required more internal maintenance; (4) _____, it offered greater control over sensitive data. After completing a proof of concept, the team decided (5) _____ the open-source solution.

- | | | |
|-----------------|---------------|--------------|
| 1. a) who | b) that | c) where |
| 2. a) test | b) to testing | c) testing |
| 3. a) that | b) which | c) where |
| 4. a) because | b) however | c) whereas |
| 5. a) selecting | b) select | c) to select |

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 14) Guided Peer Interview: Technology Choices

Work with a partner. Take turns asking and answering the questions. Ask at least one follow-up question after each answer.

1. What technology or software tool do you use most frequently?
2. What features make that tool useful for you?
3. Which is more important when selecting technology: cost, security, usability or scalability? Why?
4. Would you prefer to use a cloud-based service or an open-source solution?
5. Would you consider paying a monthly subscription for reliable technical support? Why or why not?
6. What problems can vendor lock-in create for a company?
7. Why should a team create a proof of concept before selecting a system?
8. Who should participate in the technology-selection process?

Follow-up questions

- Why do you think that?
- Can you give me an example?
- What would be the main advantage?
- What could be a possible disadvantage?
- How would you compare it with another option?

Language Support

- The tool **that I use most frequently** is...
- I prefer using... because...
- I would consider choosing...
- Both alternatives...
- Unlike..., ...
- ...is easier to use, whereas...
- The main reason is that...
- One possible disadvantage is...

Partner Report

After the interview, report your partner's ideas in four complete sentences.

1. My partner prefers _____.
2. The technology that _____.
3. They would consider _____.
4. Their main reason for choosing this option is _____.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 15) - Work in pairs. Student A receives **Role Card A** and Student B receives **Role Card B**. Do not show your card to your partner.

Ask and answer the six questions to complete the missing information. Then compare the platforms and agree on one recommendation.

Questions

1. How long would deployment take?
2. What are the initial and regular costs?
3. Where would the company's data be stored?
4. Who would be responsible for maintenance and updates?
5. Which existing tools can the platform integrate with?
6. How scalable is the platform?

ROLE CARD A — CLOUDDesk

You are presenting a cloud-based support platform.

Category	Information
Deployment	Two working days
Cost	No initial installation cost; USD 220 per month
Data storage	Provider's cloud servers
Maintenance	Automatic updates and 24/7 technical support
Integration	Email and common collaboration tools
Scalability	Supports up to 1,000 users without additional infrastructure

Ask Student B for information about **OpenSupport**.

ROLE CARD B — OPENSUPPORT

You are presenting an open-source support platform.

Category	Information
Deployment	Approximately three weeks
Cost	No subscription fee; USD 1,800 initial configuration cost
Data storage	Company's own servers
Maintenance	Internal IT team manages updates and security
Integration	Existing database and authentication system
Scalability	Can expand, but additional hardware may be necessary after 500 users

Ask Student A for information about **CloudDesk**.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

Model Exchange

Student A: How long would deploying OpenSupport take?

Student B: It would take approximately three weeks. What about CloudDesk?

Student A: CloudDesk, which is hosted by the provider, could be deployed in two working days.

Compare the Platforms

Use your completed information to discuss:

- deployment time;
- short-term and long-term costs;
- data control and security;
- maintenance responsibilities;
- integration;
- scalability;
- possible vendor lock-in.

Required Answer Patterns

- The platform **that offers the fastest deployment** is...
- CloudDesk, **which includes technical support**, ...
- Both platforms...
- Unlike CloudDesk, OpenSupport...
- Using _____ would allow the company to...
- We recommend choosing _____ because...
- The main reason for our decision is that...

Final Decision

We recommend _____ because _____

ACTIVITY 16) - Choose one role card. Prepare and deliver a two- to three-minute professional recommendation.

You will have **three minutes to prepare**. After your presentation, answer at least two questions from your classmates.

ROLE CARD 1 — PROJECT MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

You are an IT consultant for a growing software start-up.

The company must choose between:

- a cloud-based platform that is quick to deploy and includes support but requires a monthly subscription;
- an open-source platform that offers greater control but requires internal maintenance.

Important requirements:

- remote access;
- easy onboarding;
- integration with communication tools;
- support for future growth;
- limited initial budget.

Recommend one alternative and justify your decision.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ROLE CARD 2 — E-COMMERCE DATABASE

You are a systems analyst for an online retailer whose customer base is growing rapidly.

The company must choose between:

- a relational database that is reliable, familiar and easy to integrate;
- a NoSQL database that offers greater scalability but requires additional staff training.

Important requirements:

- reliable transaction processing;
- fast access to product information;
- scalability;
- compatibility with existing systems;
- manageable training costs.

Recommend one alternative and justify your decision.

ROLE CARD 3 — MEDICAL CENTRE DATA STORAGE

You are an infrastructure adviser for a medical centre.

The organisation must choose between:

- storing information on its own servers, which offers direct control but requires maintenance;
- using a cloud-storage provider, which offers automatic backups and flexible capacity but involves a subscription and external data storage.

Important requirements:

- protection of sensitive information;
- reliable backups;
- controlled access;
- system availability;
- predictable long-term costs.

Recommend one alternative and justify your decision.

Presentation Structure

1. **Introduce the situation**
 - The organisation needs a system that...
 - The main requirements are...
2. **Compare the alternatives**
 - Both alternatives...
 - Unlike Option A, Option B...
 - Option A is..., whereas Option B...
 - One advantage of choosing... is...
3. **Present and justify your recommendation**
 - After comparing the alternatives, I recommend...
 - The main reason is that...
 - This option would allow the organisation to...
 - A possible drawback is...; however,...
4. **Suggest the next step**
 - The team should consider creating...
 - I suggest testing...
 - The organisation should plan to...

Follow-up Questions

- Why did you reject the other alternative?
- Which requirement influenced your decision most?

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

- What is the main risk associated with your recommendation?
- Would your decision change if the organisation had a larger budget?
- How could the team test the solution before full deployment?

LISTENING COMPREHENSION

You will hear a conversation between a project manager and a systems analyst. They are discussing the results of a technology evaluation. You will hear the recording **twice**.

ACTIVITY 17) - Listen and choose the correct option.

1. *What is the main purpose of the conversation?*

- a) To explain how to install a support platform.
- b) To compare two systems and present a final recommendation.
- c) To report a security incident involving customer data.
- d) To negotiate the price of a cloud subscription.

2. *Why does BrightWave need to replace its current platform?*

- a) It does not include automatic updates.
- b) Its subscription has become too expensive.
- c) It is slow and does not integrate easily with other systems.
- d) It cannot support employees who work in the office.

3. *What is one important advantage of CloudConnect?*

- a) It stores all information on the company's own servers.
- b) It can be deployed quickly and includes technical support.
- c) It does not require a subscription.
- d) It offers unlimited control over its source code.

4. *What is a potential disadvantage of OpenTrack?*

- a) It cannot integrate with BrightWave's database.
- b) It does not allow the company to control its data.
- c) It can only support twenty employees.
- d) The internal IT team must manage maintenance and security.

5. *Why does the systems analyst recommend OpenTrack?*

- a) It has no configuration costs and can be installed immediately.
- b) It provides greater data control, better integration and lower long-term costs.
- c) Employees found it easier to learn than CloudConnect.
- d) The external provider agreed to reduce its monthly fee.

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

ACTIVITY 18) Technology Evaluation Profile

Listen again and complete the profile. Write **NO MORE THAN FOUR WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Category	Information
1. Company	_____
2. Current number of users	_____
3. Expected number of users	_____
4. Proof-of-concept test group	_____
5. Test duration	_____
6. CloudConnect deployment time	_____
7. CloudConnect subscription	_____
8. OpenTrack deployment time	_____
9. OpenTrack data location	_____
10. Recommended solution	_____

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 19) - Choose the correct option.

- The systems analyst _____ evaluated both platforms presented the final recommendation.
a) which
b) whose
c) who
d) where
- DataCore, _____ was selected after the proof of concept, can integrate with the company's existing tools.
a) that
b) which
c) where
d) whose
- The company needs a provider _____ security policy meets international standards.
a) who
b) which
c) whose
d) where
- A test environment is a controlled space _____ teams can evaluate a system safely.
a) because
b) whereas
c) therefore
d) both
- The company wants to avoid _____ completely on a single technology provider.
a) which
b) who
c) whose
d) where
- The project manager agreed _____ a proof of concept before the final decision.
a) depend
b) depending
c) to depend
d) depended
- The cloud service is easier to deploy, _____ the open-source platform offers greater control over data.
a) create
b) creating
c) to create
d) created

Unit 7: Choosing the Right Technology

8. The monthly subscription was too expensive; _____, the team selected the open-source solution.
- a) however
b) whereas
c) therefore
d) unlike

ACTIVITY 20) - Complete the second sentence so that it has the same meaning as the first. Use the word in brackets without changing it.

1. The system stores the company's sensitive information. It must be secure.
The system _____ must be secure. **(THAT)**
2. OpenDesk is maintained by an international community. It receives frequent security updates.
OpenDesk, _____, receives frequent security updates. **(WHICH)**
3. The company selected a provider. Its technical support team is available 24/7.
The company selected a provider _____ available 24/7. **(WHOSE)**
4. The team thought about using a cloud-based service.
The team _____ a cloud-based service. **(CONSIDERED)**
5. The engineers made a decision to create a test environment.
The engineers _____ a test environment. **(DECIDED)**
6. CloudDesk supports remote access. OpenSupport also supports remote access.
_____ support remote access. **(BOTH)**
7. OpenSupport does not require a monthly subscription, but CloudDesk does.
_____, CloudDesk requires a monthly subscription. **(UNLIKE)**
8. The team selected the platform since it met all the security requirements.
The team selected the platform _____ all the security requirements. **(BECAUSE)**

ACTIVITY 21) - Complete the text with the words and expressions from the box. There are two extra options.

which – whose – where – using – depending – to create – whereas – therefore – who – because

NextWave, (1) _____ develops online payment systems, needed to replace its internal support platform. The team contacted a technology provider (2) _____ support department was available 24/7. They also prepared a controlled environment (3) _____ employees could test different solutions safely.

The project team considered (4) _____ a cloud-based service because it was easy to deploy. However, the company wanted to avoid (5) _____ completely on one external provider. The engineers decided (6) _____ a proof of concept to compare the cloud service with an open-source platform.

The cloud service included automatic maintenance, (7) _____ the open-source solution offered greater control over data storage. The open-source platform met the company's most important security and integration requirements; (8) _____, the team recommended selecting it.



TALLER DE INGLÉS

UNIT 8

NIVEL 2

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Unit 8

Team Communication & Project Reporting



By the end of the unit the student will be able to:

- report statements and simple questions using appropriate **reported speech** structures.
- understand and summarize information from meetings, stand-ups, and project reports.
- use discourse connectors to organize spoken and written information clearly.
- participate in discussions about project progress using appropriate professional language.
- write clear meeting minutes and project summaries for a professional audience.
- communicate effectively in collaborative software development contexts.

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

WARM-UP

Activity 1 – Before You Read: What Should Be Included?

A. *Imagine your software development team has just finished its weekly sprint meeting.*

In pairs, discuss:

1. What topics are usually discussed during a sprint meeting?
2. Who normally participates?
3. Why is it important to keep written records of meetings?
4. What information should appear in meeting minutes?

→ Complete the chart.

Include	Don't include

Activity 2 – Before You Read: Who Said It?

Below are four comments made during a software project meeting. Match each comment with the most likely speaker.

➤ **Speakers**

- Project Manager
- Software Developer
- QA Engineer
- UX Designer

➤ **Comments**

A. "I found three critical bugs during yesterday's testing."

B. "The login screen should be simpler."

C. "We need to finish the API integration before Friday."

D. "I'll update the project schedule after today's meeting."

→ **Compare your answers with a partner.**

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting



READING DIMENSION

PART 1: READING INPUT - “When One Weak Password Becomes Everyone's Problem”

Sprint Review Meeting Minutes: Orion Mobile Banking Project

Date: Monday, 18 May

Participants: Project Manager, Backend Developers, Frontend Developers, QA Engineers, UX Designer

The meeting began with a review of the previous sprint. The Project Manager explained that most development tasks had been completed on schedule, although the integration of the payment API had taken longer than expected.

The Backend Team reported that the database migration had been completed successfully and that performance had improved after several queries were optimized. However, one developer mentioned that a synchronization problem had been discovered during final testing.

The QA Engineers informed the team that they had identified four critical bugs affecting user authentication. They added that two of the bugs had already been fixed, while the remaining issues would be addressed before the next release.

The UX Designer suggested simplifying the registration process because several users had reported difficulties creating new accounts during usability testing.

Before closing the meeting, the Project Manager reminded everyone that the release candidate would be deployed on Thursday. She also asked the team to complete all documentation before the deployment date.

Finally, the team agreed that communication between developers and testers had improved during the sprint, but everyone recognized that earlier reporting of technical issues would help prevent delays in future releases.



ACTIVITY 1 – Reading for Main Ideas: Complete the meeting overview.

Topic	Main Information
Project progress	
Main technical problem	
QA results	
UX recommendation	
Next actions	

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

ACTIVITY 2 – Reading Detective: *Read the meeting minutes again. Decide **who provided each piece of information.***

Information	Who said it?
The database migration was successful.	
Four critical bugs were identified.	
The registration process should be simplified.	
Documentation must be completed before Thursday.	
Communication has improved during the sprint.	

ACTIVITY 3 – Reading Between the Lines: *Answer the questions.*

1. Why do you think the API integration took longer than expected?

2. Why were only two of the bugs fixed immediately?

3. Why did the UX Designer recommend simplifying the registration process?

4. Why is completing the documentation before deployment important?

5. What lesson did the team learn from this sprint?

ACTIVITY 4 – From Direct Speech to Reported Information: *The following statements were made during the meeting. Find the corresponding information in the meeting minutes and underline it.*

Direct Speech	How is it reported in the text?
"The database migration is finished."	
"We found four critical bugs."	
"Users are having problems creating accounts."	
"Please finish the documentation before Thursday."	
"Communication has improved."	

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

VOCABULARY

ACTIVITY 5 – Vocabulary in Context: *Go back to the reading text. Match each word from the reading to its definition.*

Word / Expression	Definition
1. sprint	a. a problem that affects how software works
2. deployment	b. a short development cycle in Agile projects
3. bug	c. the process of releasing software to users
4. usability testing	d. evaluating how easy a product is to use
5. release candidate	e. a version that is almost ready for release
6. action item	f. a task assigned to be completed after a meeting

ACTIVITY 6 – Reporting Verbs: *Different reporting verbs express different communicative purposes. Match each reporting verb with its typical function.*

Reporting Verb	Definition
1. explain	a. to make a recommendation or propose an idea
2. report	b. to give reasons or make something easier to understand
3. suggest	c. to give factual information about a situation, event, or result
4. remind	d. to help someone remember something important
5. agree	e. to have the same opinion or reach the same decision

ACTIVITY 7 – Meeting Expressions: *Complete the meeting summary using the expressions below.*

agreed • reminded • reported • suggested • explained • identified

Yesterday, the development team held its weekly sprint review.

The Project Manager (1) _____ that most tasks had been completed on time.

The QA engineers (2) _____ several critical bugs during testing.

The UX Designer (3) _____ simplifying the registration process.

Before ending the meeting, the Project Manager (4) _____ everyone about Thursday's deployment.

Finally, the whole team (5) _____ that communication had improved, but they also (6) _____ that earlier reporting of technical problems would reduce future delays.

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

GRAMMAR FOCUS

GRAMMAR OVERVIEW

1. Reported Speech: Statements and Questions

In professional IT environments, we often need to report what other people have said rather than repeat their exact words.

This happens when writing:

- meeting minutes
- incident reports
- project updates
- sprint reviews
- client summaries
- technical documentation

Instead of quoting people's exact words (**direct speech**), we usually report the information (**reported speech**).

→ Direct Speech vs. Reported Speech

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
"The deployment was successful," the Project Manager said.	The Project Manager said that the deployment had been successful.
"We found four critical bugs," the QA Engineer said.	The QA Engineer reported that they had found four critical bugs.
"Users are experiencing login problems," the Help Desk technician said.	The Help Desk technician explained that users were experiencing login problems.
"The release will be postponed," the manager said.	The manager said that the release would be postponed.

Form

Reporting Statements	Reporting Questions	
	Yes / No Questions	Wh- Questions
Reporting verb + (that) + reported clause	Questions become statements. We do not use question word order. → asked if / whether	Questions become statements. We do not use question word order. → Keep the question word.
Examples The developer said (that) the deployment had failed. The QA engineer reported (that) several bugs had been identified.	Direct "Did you test the update?" Reported The manager asked if they had tested the update.	Direct "Why did the deployment fail?" Reported The manager asked why the deployment had failed.

→ Backshifting

When the reporting verb is in the past, the verb tense often moves one step back.

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
Present Simple	Past Simple
Present Continuous	Past Continuous
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Past Simple	Past Perfect
will	would
can	could

→ Time Expression Changes

Some expressions also change.

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
today	that day
yesterday	the previous day
tomorrow	the following day
last week	the previous week
next sprint	the following sprint
now	then
here	there

ACTIVITY 8 – Direct or Reported?: Decide whether each sentence is written in Direct Speech (D) or Reported Speech (R).

1. The QA Engineer reported that two bugs had been fixed.
2. "The deployment finished successfully," the developer said.
3. The Project Manager explained that the documentation was incomplete.
4. "We will release the update tomorrow," the Scrum Master said.
5. The client asked whether the problem had been solved.
6. "Why did the server stop responding?" the technician asked.

ACTIVITY 9 – Reporting the Meeting: Rewrite the following statements using reported speech.

1. "The deployment was successful."

The Project Manager said _____

2. "We found three security vulnerabilities."

The Cybersecurity Specialist reported _____

3. "The users cannot access the application."

The Help Desk technician explained _____

4. "Will the release be delayed?"

The client asked _____

5. "Why did the system crash?"

The manager asked _____

6. "We will deploy the new version next Friday."

The Backend Team said _____

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

ACTIVITY 10 – Grammar in Context: Complete the meeting summary using the correct form of the verbs.

Sprint Meeting Summary

During yesterday's sprint review, the Project Manager (1) _____ (say) that the development team (2) _____ (complete) all the planned tasks before the deadline.

The QA Engineers (3) _____ (report) that they (4) _____ (test) the latest version when they discovered two critical security vulnerabilities.

One of the developers (5) _____ (explain) that the API (6) _____ (not work) correctly because the authentication service had failed.

The client (7) _____ (ask) whether the mobile application (8) _____ (be) ready for release the following week.

The Scrum Master (9) _____ (remind) the team that they (10) _____ (have to) complete all the documentation before deployment.

Finally, everyone (11) _____ (agree) that communication between developers and testers (12) _____ (improve) significantly since the previous sprint.

SPEAKING - PAIR / GROUP WORK

ACTIVITY 11 – Sprint Meeting Role Play

Instructions

Work in groups of three.

1. Each student receives a different role card.
2. Read your information carefully.
3. Hold a short sprint meeting.
4. At the end, one student summarizes the discussion using reported speech.

→ Role Card A – Project Manager

You are leading today's sprint meeting.

You say:

- "The deployment is scheduled for Friday."
- "We need to finish the documentation before Thursday."
- "Please update the project board this afternoon."

→ Role Card B – QA Engineer

You report the testing results.

You say:

- "We found two critical bugs."
- "The authentication module is working correctly."
- "The payment system still needs more testing."

→ Role Card C – UX Designer

You discuss the user interface.

You say:

- "Users had difficulty finding the Settings menu."
- "The registration form should be shorter."
- "The new design is much easier to use."

→ After the meeting:

One student reports the discussion to another group.

Example:

The Project Manager said that the deployment was scheduled for Friday. The QA Engineer reported that they had found two critical bugs. The UX Designer suggested that the registration form should be shorter.

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

ACTIVITY 12 - Information Gap: The Missing Meeting

Instructions: *Work in pairs: Student A and Student B attended different project meetings.*

- Do not show your card to your partner.
- Ask questions to complete the missing information.
- When you finish, summarize what your partner told you using reported speech.

Student A

You attended the **Development Meeting**.

Topic	Information
Deployment	Friday afternoon
API	Finished successfully
Database	Needs optimization
Documentation	Not completed
Next task	Security testing

Student B

You attended the **Testing Meeting**.

Topic	Information
Authentication	Two bugs found
Performance	Improved
User Interface	New design approved
Documentation	Updated yesterday
Next task	Final system testing

→ Questions

- What did the team say about...?
- Was the deployment completed?
- What problems were reported?
- What did they decide?
- What is the next task?

→ Final Report

Complete these sentences.

- My partner said that...
- They reported that...
- They explained that...
- They also mentioned that...
- Finally, they said that...

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

WRITING

ACTIVITY 13 – Writing an Internal Meeting Summary

→ **Situation:** *You attended a sprint review meeting after the latest software release. During the meeting, different team members discussed the progress of the project, reported problems, and agreed on the next steps.*

Your task is to write a **meeting summary (120–150 words)** for colleagues who could not attend.

	Meeting Notes <i>Use the information below.</i>
	→ <u>Project Manager</u> • "The deployment was completed on time." • "Documentation must be updated this week." → <u>QA Engineer</u> • "We found three minor bugs." • "None of them affects system security." → <u>UX Designer</u> • "Users preferred the new dashboard." • "The settings menu should be simplified." → <u>Backend Developer</u> • "The API response time has improved." • "Database optimisation will continue next sprint."

→ **Your summary should include:**

- a title
- an introductory sentence
- the main decisions discussed
- the reported comments from each team member

Suggested Structure

→ **Title:** *Sprint Review Meeting Summary*

→ **Introduction:** *State when the meeting took place and its purpose.*

→ **Main Discussion:** *Report the main information shared by each participant.*

→ **Next Steps:** *Summarize the team's decisions and future actions.*

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 14 – Choose the correct option.

Choose the best answer

1. During the sprint review, the QA Engineer said that they _____ three critical bugs.
 - a) found
 - b) had found
 - c) have found
2. The Project Manager reminded the team that the documentation _____ before deployment.
 - a) had to be completed
 - b) has to complete
 - c) completed

Unit 8: Team Communication & Project Reporting

3. The client asked _____ the new version would be released.
 - a) if
 - b) why
 - c) when
4. The UX Designer explained that users _____ difficulty finding the Settings menu.
 - a) had experienced
 - b) experience
 - c) were experience
5. _____ the meeting, the team agreed to postpone the deployment until Friday.
 - a) However
 - b) During
 - c) Finally
6. The Scrum Master reported that communication between developers and testers _____ significantly.
 - a) improved
 - b) had improved
 - c) improve
7. The Systems Administrator asked _____ the backup had been tested.
 - a) if
 - b) that
 - c) what
8. The Network Engineer mentioned that the API response time _____ by 20%.
 - a) had improved
 - b) improve
 - c) was improve

ACTIVITY 15 – Rewrite the Sentences Using Reported Speech: Rewrite each sentence using the reporting verb provided.

1. "We have fixed the login problem."
(report)

2. "The deployment will begin tomorrow."
(say)

3. "Did you update the documentation?"
(ask)

4. "Why did the server restart?"
(ask)

5. "You should test the backup before deployment."
(remind)

6. "The application is running normally now."
(explain)

7. "We identified two security vulnerabilities."
(report)

8. "The client approved the new interface."
(mention)
